

# Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve

## SEACAR Habitat Analyses

Last compiled on 10 June, 2026

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## Funding & Acknowledgements

The data used in this analysis is from the Export Standardized Tables in the SEACAR Data Discovery Interface (DDI). Documents and information available through the SEACAR DDI are owned by the data provider(s) and users are expected to provide appropriate credit following accepted citation formats. Users are encouraged to access data to maximize utilization of gained knowledge, reducing redundant research and facilitating partnerships and scientific innovation.

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## Threshold Filtering

Threshold filters, following the guidance of Florida Department of Environmental Protection's (*FDEP*) Division of Environmental Assessment and Restoration (*DEAR*) are used to exclude specific results values from the SEACAR Analysis. Based on the threshold filters, Quality Assurance / Quality Control (*QAQC*) Flags are inserted into the *SEACAR\_QAQCFlagCode* and *SEACAR\_QAQC\_Description* columns of the export data. The *Include* column indicates whether the *QAQC* Flag will also indicate that data are excluded from analysis. No data are excluded from the data export, but the analysis scripts can use the *Include* column to exclude data (1 to include, 0 to exclude).

Table 1: Continuous Water Quality threshold values

| <i>Parameter Name</i>                     | <i>Units</i> | <i>Low Threshold</i> | <i>High Threshold</i> |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------|----------------------|-----------------------|
| Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin | ug/L         | -                    | -                     |
| Dissolved Oxygen                          | mg/L         | -0.000001            | 50                    |
| Dissolved Oxygen Saturation               | %            | -0.000001            | 500                   |
| Fluorescent Dissolved Organic Matter      | QSE          | -                    | -                     |
| Salinity                                  | ppt          | -0.000001            | 70                    |
| Specific Conductivity                     | mS/cm        | -0.000001            | 200                   |
| Turbidity                                 | NTU          | -0.000001            | 4000                  |
| Water Temperature                         | Degrees C    | -5.000000            | 45                    |
| pH                                        | None         | 2.000000             | 14                    |

Table 2: Discrete Water Quality threshold values

| <i>Parameter Name</i>     | <i>Units</i> | <i>Low Threshold</i> | <i>High Threshold</i> |
|---------------------------|--------------|----------------------|-----------------------|
| Ammonia, Un-ionized (NH3) | mg/L         | -                    | -                     |
| Ammonium (NH4)            | mg/L         | -                    | -                     |

| <i>Parameter Name</i>                     | <i>Units</i>    | <i>Low Threshold</i> | <i>High Threshold</i> |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------|----------------------|-----------------------|
| Chlorophyll a, Corrected for Pheophytin   | ug/L            | -                    | -                     |
| Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin | ug/L            | -                    | -                     |
| Colored Dissolved Organic Matter          | PCU             | -                    | -                     |
| Dissolved Oxygen                          | mg/L            | -0.000001            | 25                    |
| Dissolved Oxygen Saturation               | %               | -0.000001            | 310                   |
| Fluorescent Dissolved Organic Matter      | QSE             | -                    | -                     |
| Light Extinction Coefficient              | m <sup>-1</sup> | -                    | -                     |
| NO2+3, Filtered                           | mg/L            | -                    | -                     |
| Nitrate (NO3)                             | mg/L            | -                    | -                     |
| Nitrite (NO2)                             | mg/L            | -                    | -                     |
| Nitrogen, inorganic                       | mg/L            | -                    | -                     |
| Nitrogen, organic                         | mg/L            | -                    | -                     |
| Phosphate, Filtered (PO4)                 | mg/L            | -                    | -                     |
| Salinity                                  | ppt             | -0.000001            | 70                    |
| Secchi Depth                              | m               | 0.000001             | 50                    |
| Specific Conductivity                     | mS/cm           | 0.005000             | 100                   |
| Total Ammonia (N)                         | mg/L            | -                    | -                     |
| Total Kjeldahl Nitrogen                   | mg/L            | -                    | -                     |
| Total Nitrogen                            | mg/L            | -                    | -                     |
| Total Nitrogen                            | mg/L            | -                    | -                     |
| Total Phosphorus                          | mg/L            | -                    | -                     |
| Total Suspended Solids                    | mg/L            | -                    | -                     |
| Turbidity                                 | NTU             | -                    | -                     |
| Water Temperature                         | Degrees C       | 3.000000             | 40                    |
| pH                                        | None            | 2.000000             | 13                    |

Table 3: Quality Assurance Flags inserted based on threshold checks listed in Table 1 and 2

| <i>SEACAR QAQC Description</i>           | <i>Include</i> | <i>SEACAR QAQCFlagCode</i> |
|------------------------------------------|----------------|----------------------------|
| Exceeds maximum threshold                | 0              | 2Q                         |
| Below minimum threshold                  | 0              | 4Q                         |
| Within threshold tolerance               | 1              | 6Q                         |
| No defined thresholds for this parameter | 1              | 7Q                         |

## Value Qualifiers

Value qualifier codes included within the data are used to exclude certain results from the analysis. The data are retained in the data export files, but the analysis uses the *Include* column to filter the results.

### STORET and WIN value qualifier codes

Value qualifier codes from *STORET* and *WIN* data are examined with the database and used to populate the *Include* column in data exports.

Table 4: Value Qualifier codes excluded from analysis

| <i>Qualifier Source</i> | <i>Value Qualifier</i> | <i>Include</i> | <i>MDL</i> | <i>Description</i>                                                       |
|-------------------------|------------------------|----------------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| STORET-WIN              | H                      | 0              | 0          | Value based on field kit determination; results may not be accurate      |
| STORET-WIN              | J                      | 0              | 0          | Estimated value                                                          |
| STORET-WIN              | V                      | 0              | 0          | Analyte was detected at or above method detection limit                  |
| STORET-WIN              | Y                      | 0              | 0          | Lab analysis from an improperly preserved sample; data may be inaccurate |

## Discrete Water Quality Value Qualifiers

The following value qualifiers are highlighted in the Discrete Water Quality section of this report. An exception is made for **Program 476** - *Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network* and data flagged with Value Qualifier **H** are included for this program only.

**H** - Value based on field kit determination; results may not be accurate. This code shall be used if a field screening test (e.g., field gas chromatograph data, immunoassay, or vendor-supplied field kit) was used to generate the value and the field kit or method has not been recognized by the Department as equivalent to laboratory methods.

**I** - The reported value is greater than or equal to the laboratory method detection limit but less than the laboratory practical quantitation limit.

**Q** - Sample held beyond the accepted holding time. This code shall be used if the value is derived from a sample that was prepared or analyzed after the approved holding time restrictions for sample preparation or analysis.

**S** - Secchi disk visible to bottom of waterbody. The value reported is the depth of the waterbody at the location of the Secchi disk measurement.

**U** - Indicates that the compound was analyzed for but not detected. This symbol shall be used to indicate that the specified component was not detected. The value associated with the qualifier shall be the laboratory method detection limit. Unless requested by the client, less than the method detection limit values shall not be reported

## Systemwide Monitoring Program (SWMP) value qualifier codes

Value qualifier codes from the *SWMP* continuous program are examined with the database and used to populate the *Include* column in data exports. *SWMP* Qualifier Codes are indicated by *QualifierSource=SWMP*.

Table 5: SWMP Value Qualifier codes

| <i>Qualifier Source</i> | <i>Value Qualifier</i> | <i>Include</i> | <i>Description</i>                                                                           |
|-------------------------|------------------------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SWMP                    | -1                     | 1              | Optional parameter not collected                                                             |
| SWMP                    | -2                     | 0              | Missing data                                                                                 |
| SWMP                    | -3                     | 0              | Data rejected due to QA/QC                                                                   |
| SWMP                    | -4                     | 0              | Outside low sensor range                                                                     |
| SWMP                    | -5                     | 0              | Outside high sensor range                                                                    |
| SWMP                    | 0                      | 1              | Passed initial QA/QC checks                                                                  |
| SWMP                    | 1                      | 0              | Suspect data                                                                                 |
| SWMP                    | 2                      | 1              | Reserved for future use                                                                      |
| SWMP                    | 3                      | 1              | Calculated data: non-vented depth/level sensor correction for changes in barometric pressure |
| SWMP                    | 4                      | 1              | Historical: Pre-auto QA/QC                                                                   |
| SWMP                    | 5                      | 1              | Corrected data                                                                               |



## Water Column

The water column habitat extends from the water's surface to the bottom sediments, and it's where fish, dolphins, crabs and people swim! So much life makes its home in the water column that the health of marine and coastal ecosystems, as well as human economies, depend on the condition of this vulnerable habitat. Local patterns of rainfall, temperature, winds and currents can rapidly change the condition of the water column, while global influences such as [El Niño/La Niña](#), large-scale fluctuation in sea temperatures and climate change can have long-term effects. Inputs from the prosperity of our day-to-day lives including farming, mining and forestry, and emissions from power generation, automobiles and water treatment can also alter the health of the water column. Acting alone or together, each input can have complex and lasting effects on habitats and ecosystems.

SEACAR evaluates water column health with several essential parameters. These include nutrient surveys of nitrogen and phosphorus, and water quality assessments of salinity, dissolved oxygen, pH, and water temperature. Water clarity is evaluated with Secchi depth, turbidity, levels of chlorophyll a, total suspended solids, and colored dissolved organic matter. Additionally, the richness of nekton is indicated by the abundance of free-swimming fishes and macroinvertebrates like crabs and shrimps.

## Seasonal Kendall-Tau Analysis

Indicators must have a minimum of five to ten years, depending on the habitat, of data within the geographic range of the analysis to be included in the analysis. Ten years of data are required for discrete parameters, and five years of data are required for continuous parameters. If there are insufficient years of data, the number of years of data available will be noted and labeled as "insufficient data to conduct analysis". Further, for the preferred Seasonal Kendall-Tau test, there must be data from at least two months in common across at least two consecutive years within the RCP managed area being analyzed. Values that pass both of these tests will be included in the analysis and be labeled as *Use\_In\_Analysis* = **TRUE**. Any that fail either test will be excluded from the analyses and labeled as *Use\_In\_Analysis* = **FALSE**. The points for all Water Column plots displayed in this section are monthly averages. Trend significance will be denoted as "Significant Trend" (when  $p < 0.05$ ), or "Non-significant Trend" (when  $p \geq 0.05$ ). Any parameters with insufficient data to perform Seasonal Kendall-Tau test will have their monthly averages plotted without a corresponding trend line.

## Water Quality - Discrete

The following files were used in the discrete analysis:

- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_Chlorophyll\_a\_corrected\_for\_pheophytin-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_Chlorophyll\_a\_uncorrected\_for\_pheophytin-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_Colored\_dissolved\_organic\_matter\_CDOM-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_Dissolved\_Oxygen-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_Dissolved\_Oxygen\_Saturation-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_pH-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_Salinity-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_Secchi\_Depth-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_Total\_Nitrogen-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_Total\_Phosphorus-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_Total\_Suspended\_Solids\_TSS-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_Turbidity-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_Water\_Temperature-2026-May-18.txt*

# Chlorophyll a, Corrected for Pheophytin - Discrete

## Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

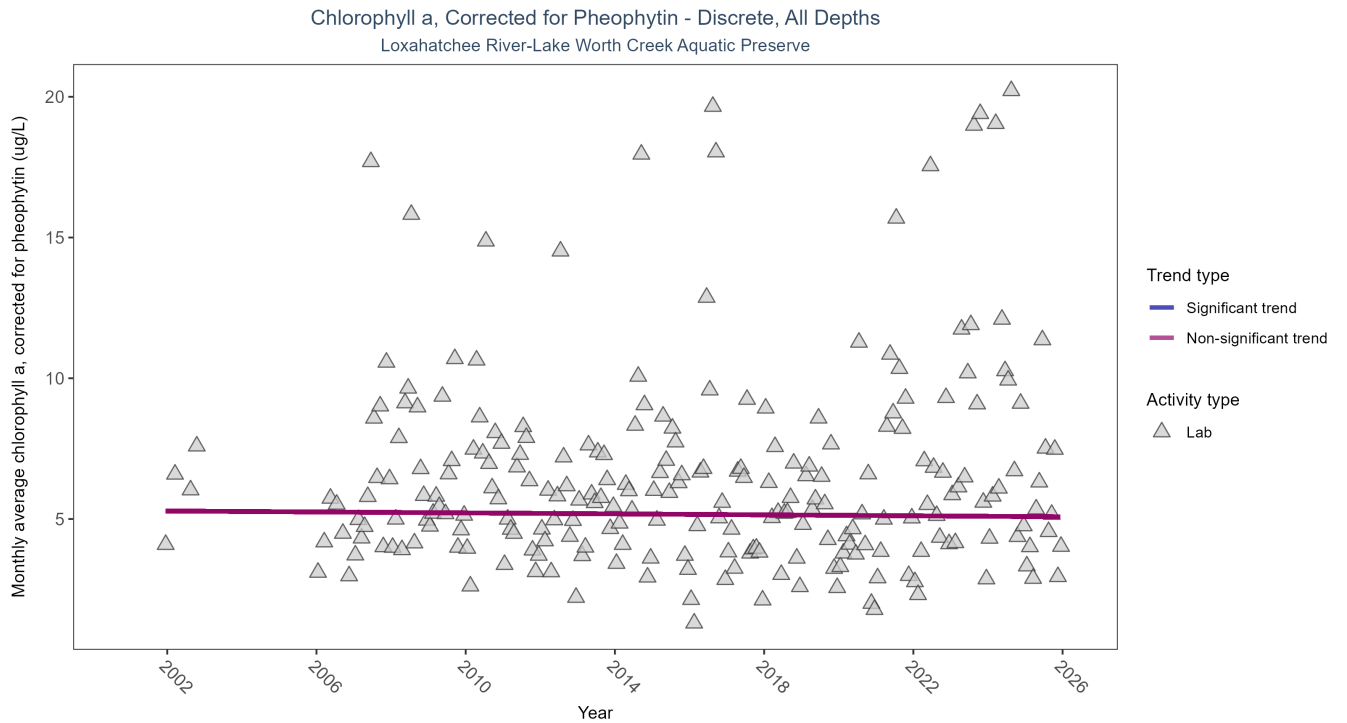


Figure 1: Scatter plot of monthly average levels of chlorophyll a, corrected for pheophytin, over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only laboratory-analyzed chlorophyll a (triangles) is included in the plot.

Table 6: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Chlorophyll a, Corrected for Pheophytin

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend   | No. of Samples | No. Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau    | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P      |
|---------------|---------------------|----------------|---------------------|------------------|---------------------|--------|---------------|-----------|--------|
| Lab           | No detectable trend | 4636           | 22                  | 2001 - 2025      | 4.5                 | -0.015 | 5.2932        | -0.0085   | 0.7331 |

Chlorophyll a, corrected for pheophytin, showed no detectable trend between 2001 and 2025.

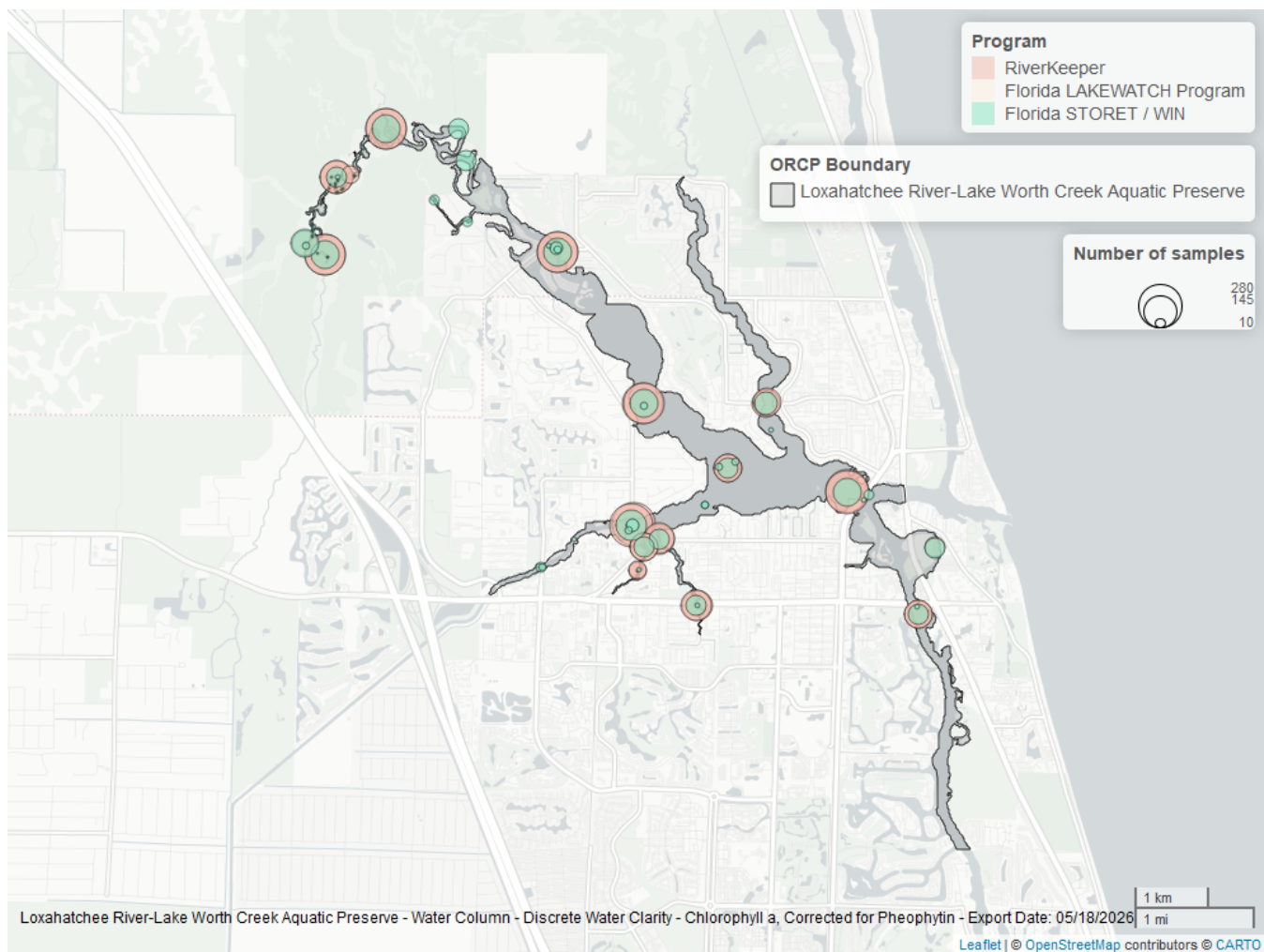


Figure 2: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 7: Programs contributing data for Chlorophyll a, Corrected for Pheophytin

| ProgramID | N_Data | YearMin | YearMax |
|-----------|--------|---------|---------|
| 10000     | 2816   | 2006    | 2025    |
| 5002      | 1816   | 2001    | 2025    |
| 514       | 48     | 2018    | 2025    |

#### Program names:

10000 - RiverKeeper<sup>1</sup>

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN<sup>2</sup>

514 - Florida LAKEWATCH Program<sup>3</sup>

#### Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin - Discrete

#### Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

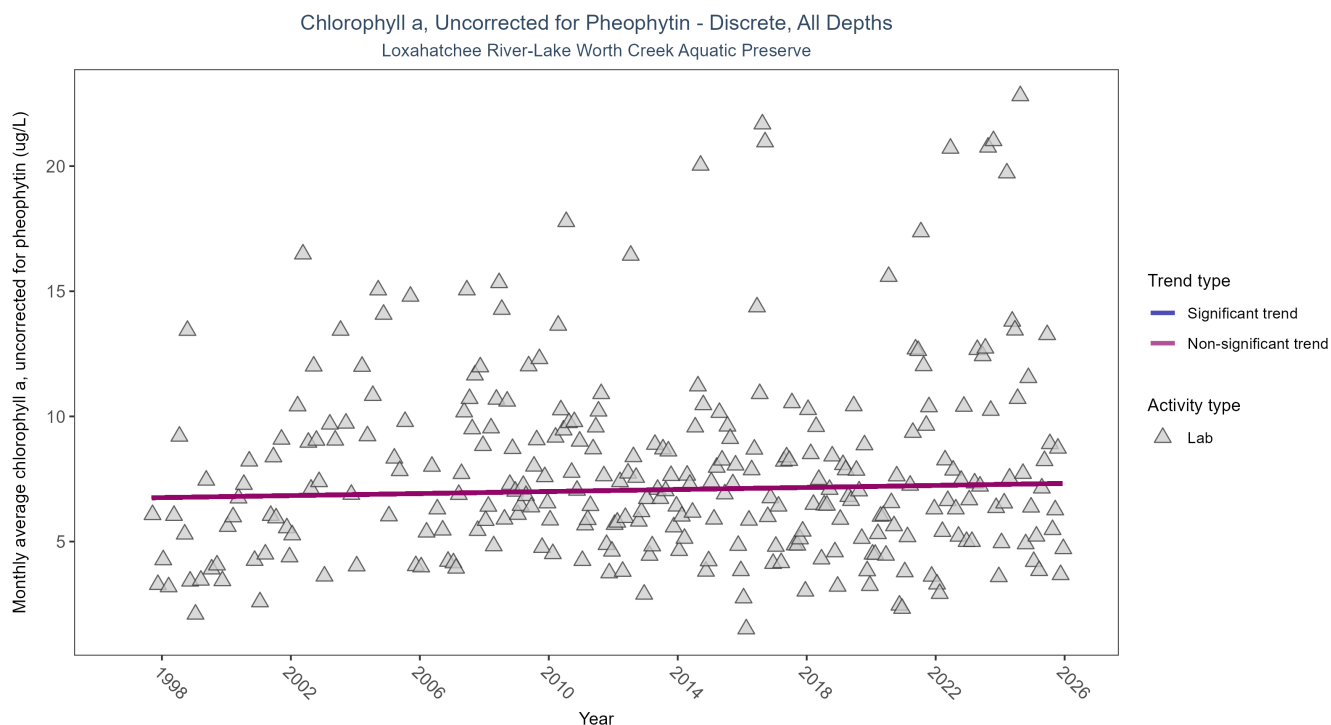


Figure 3: Scatter plot of monthly average levels of chlorophyll a, uncorrected for pheophytin, over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only laboratory-analyzed chlorophyll a (triangles) is included in the plot.

Table 8: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend   | No. of Samples | No. Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau    | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P      |
|---------------|---------------------|----------------|---------------------|------------------|---------------------|--------|---------------|-----------|--------|
| Lab           | No detectable trend | 6005           | 29                  | 1997 - 2025      | 5.6                 | 0.0347 | 6.7357        | 0.0203    | 0.3979 |

Chlorophyll a, uncorrected for pheophytin, showed no detectable trend between 1997 and 2025.

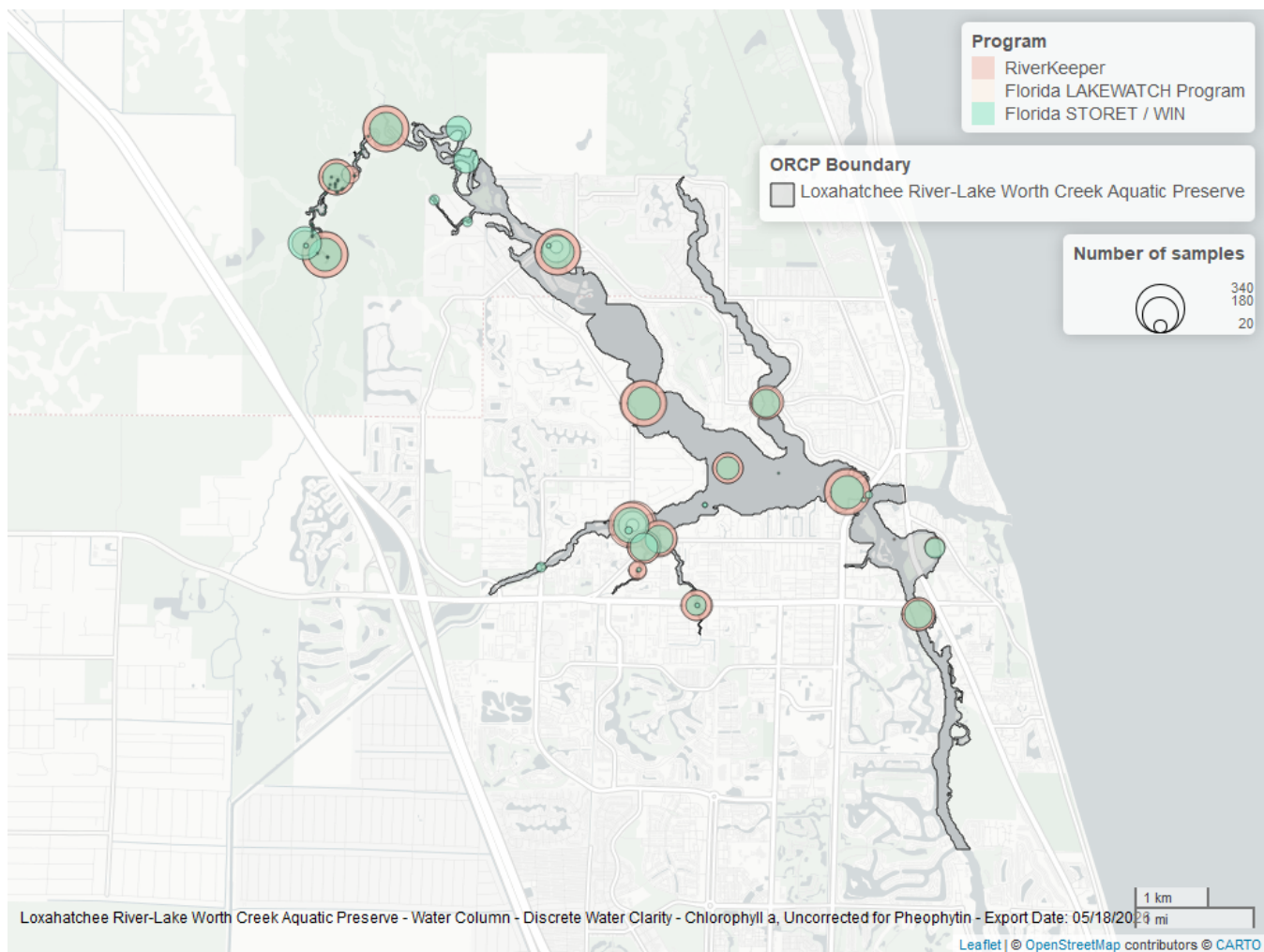


Figure 4: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 9: Programs contributing data for Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin

| ProgramID | N_Data | YearMin | YearMax |
|-----------|--------|---------|---------|
| 10000     | 3373   | 1997    | 2025    |
| 5002      | 2389   | 1997    | 2025    |
| 514       | 300    | 2001    | 2025    |

#### Program names:

10000 - RiverKeeper<sup>1</sup>

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN<sup>2</sup>

514 - Florida LAKEWATCH Program<sup>3</sup>

#### Colored Dissolved Organic Matter - Discrete

#### Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

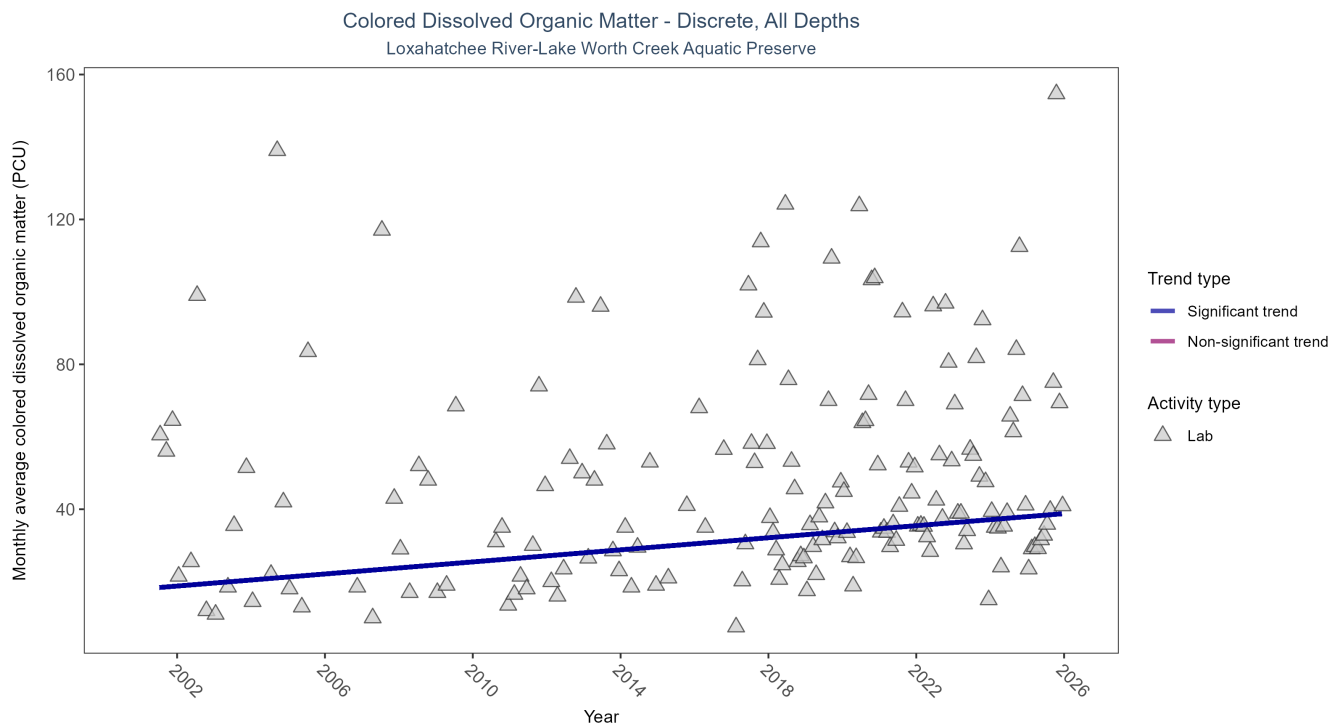


Figure 5: Scatter plot of monthly average colored dissolved organic matter (CDOM) over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only laboratory-analyzed CDOM (triangles) is included in the plot.

Table 10: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Colored Dissolved Organic Matter

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend | No. of Samples | No. Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau    | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P |
|---------------|-------------------|----------------|---------------------|------------------|---------------------|--------|---------------|-----------|---|
| Lab           | Increasing trend  | 1291           | 25                  | 2001 - 2025      | 45                  | 0.2569 | 17.9621       | 0.8333    | 0 |

Monthly average colored dissolved organic matter increased by 0.83 PCU per year, indicating a decrease in water clarity.



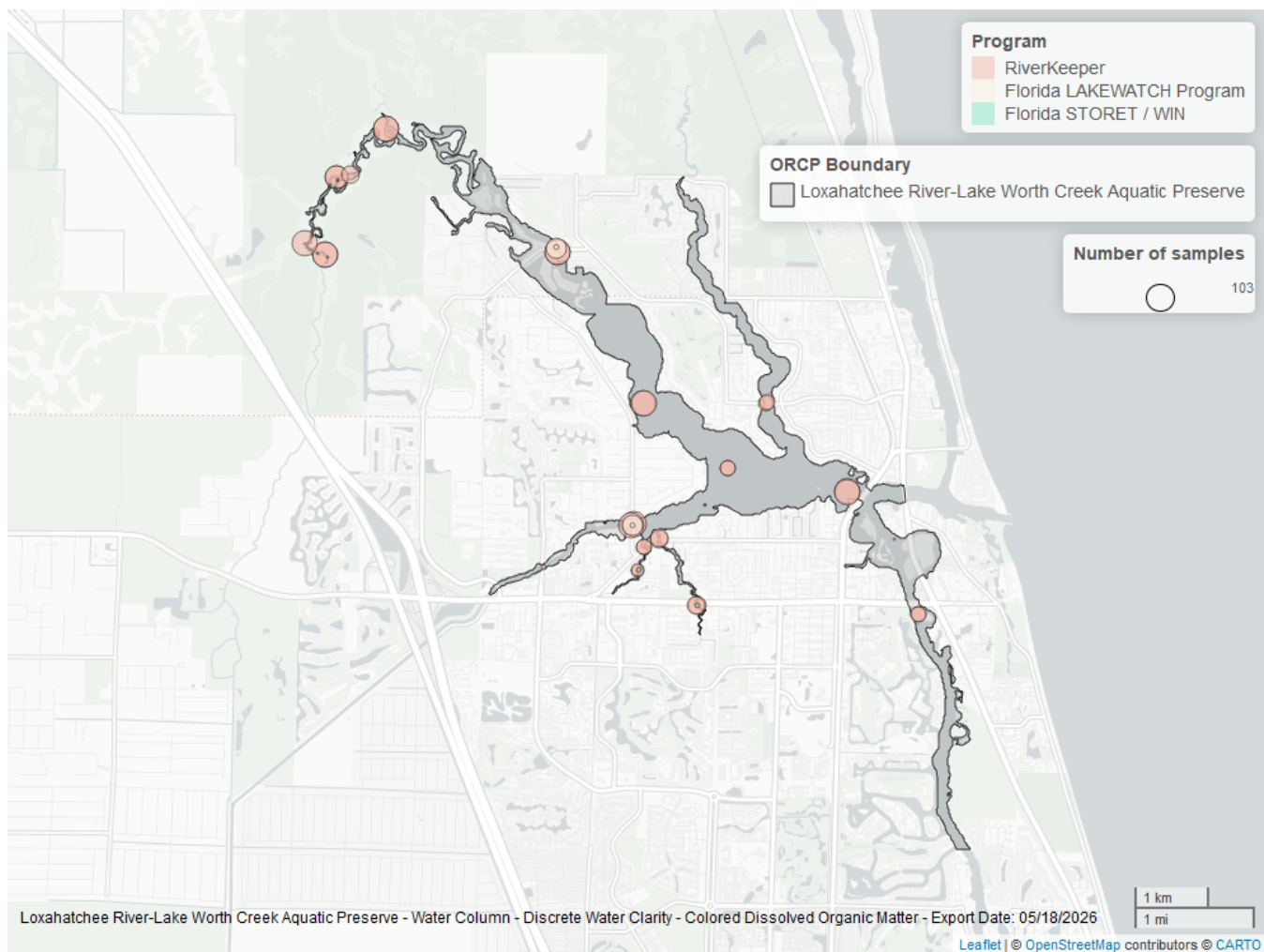


Figure 6: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 11: Programs contributing data for Colored Dissolved Organic Matter

| ProgramID | N_Data | YearMin | YearMax |
|-----------|--------|---------|---------|
| 10000     | 1126   | 2017    | 2025    |
| 514       | 140    | 2001    | 2020    |
| 5002      | 25     | 2017    | 2025    |

#### Program names:

10000 - RiverKeeper<sup>1</sup>

514 - Florida LAKEWATCH Program<sup>3</sup>

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN<sup>2</sup>

#### Dissolved Oxygen - Discrete

#### Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

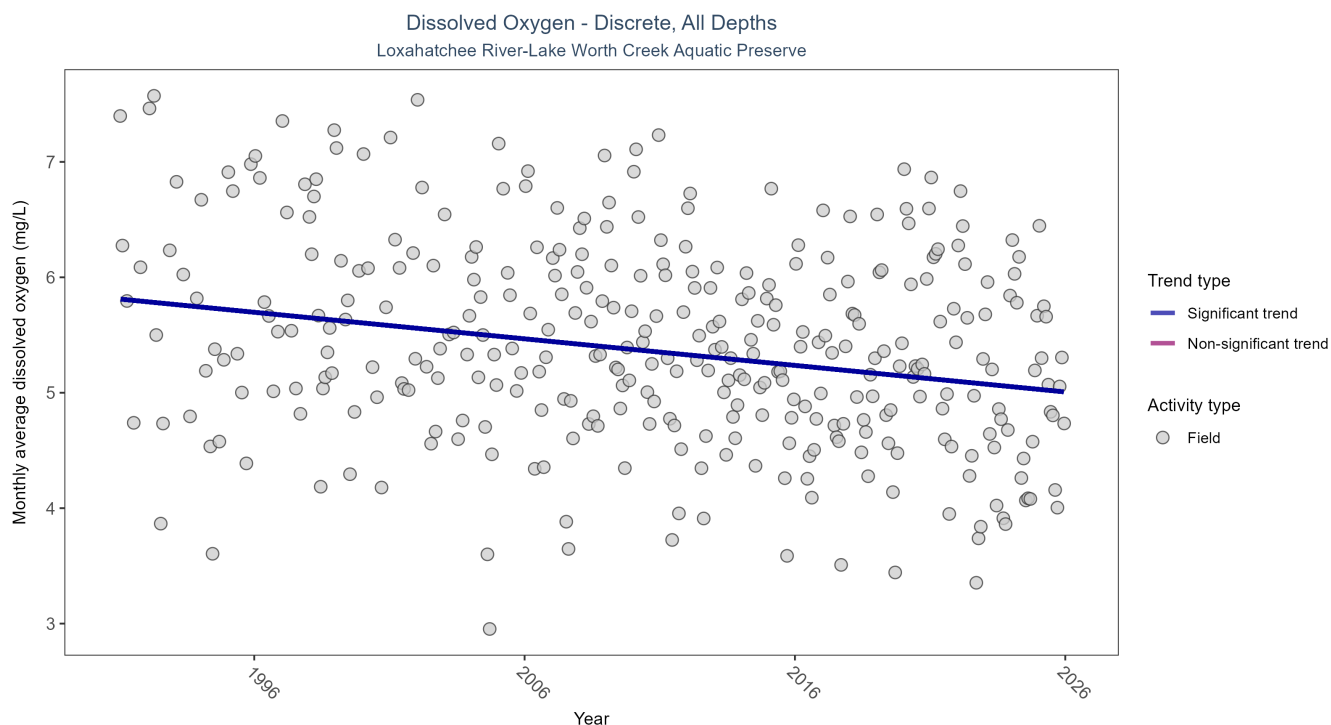


Figure 7: Scatter plot of monthly average dissolved oxygen over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only dissolved oxygen values measured in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 12: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Dissolved Oxygen

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend | No. of Samples | No. Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau     | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P |
|---------------|-------------------|----------------|---------------------|------------------|---------------------|---------|---------------|-----------|---|
| Field         | Decreasing trend  | 13210          | 35                  | 1991 - 2025      | 5.59                | -0.2628 | 5.8122        | -0.023    | 0 |

Monthly average dissolved oxygen decreased by 0.02 mg/L per year.



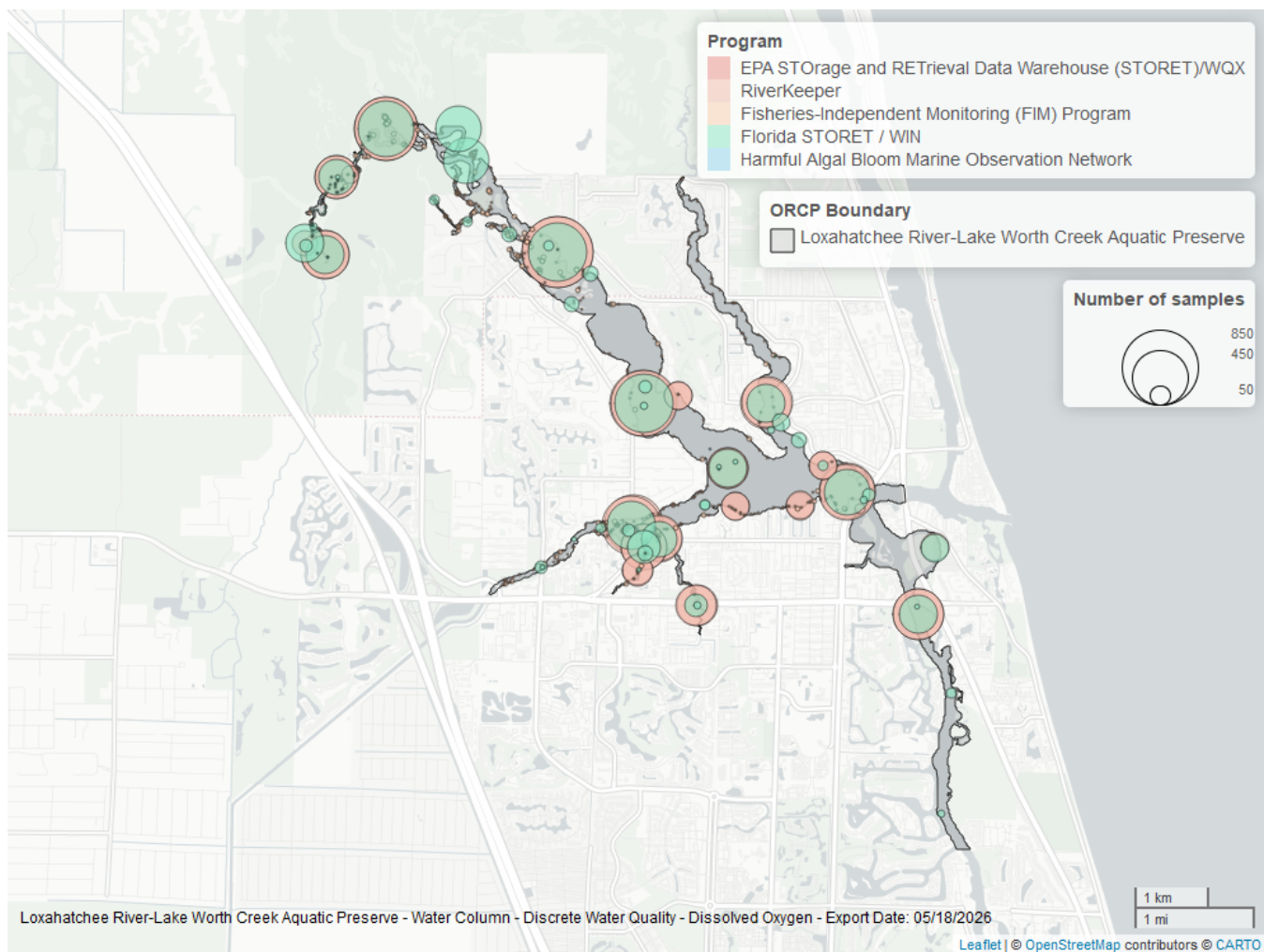


Figure 8: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 13: Programs contributing data for Dissolved Oxygen

| ProgramID | N_Data | YearMin | YearMax |
|-----------|--------|---------|---------|
| 10000     | 6628   | 1991    | 2025    |
| 5002      | 5449   | 1991    | 2025    |
| 69        | 1071   | 2014    | 2024    |
| 3013      | 71     | 2004    | 2025    |
| 95        | 2      | 2016    | 2016    |
| 103       | 2      | 2021    | 2022    |

**Program names:**

10000 - RiverKeeper<sup>1</sup>

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN<sup>2</sup>

69 - Fisheries-Independent Monitoring (FIM) Program<sup>4</sup>

3013 - Indian River Lagoon fixed seagrass transects (SJRWMD)<sup>5</sup>

95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network<sup>6</sup>

103 - EPA STORage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX<sup>7</sup>

# Dissolved Oxygen Saturation - Discrete

## Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

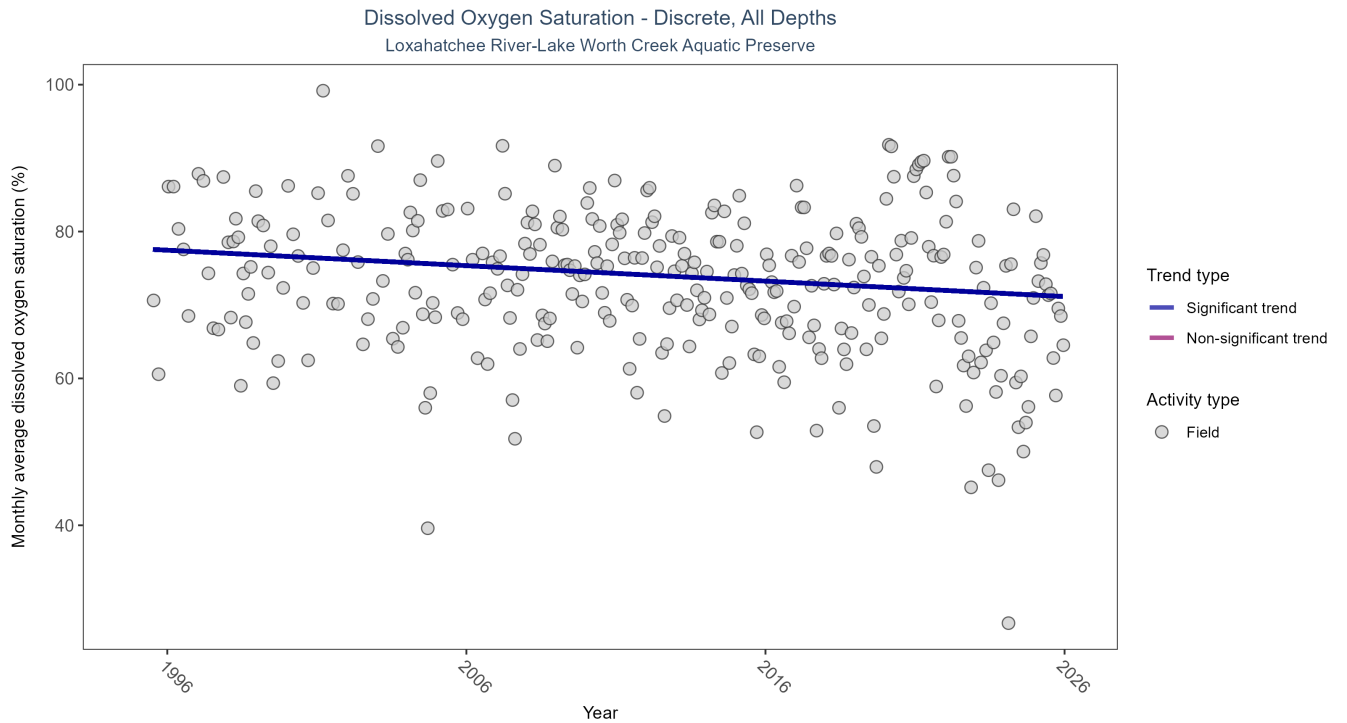


Figure 9: Scatter plot of monthly average dissolved oxygen saturation over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only dissolved oxygen saturation values measured in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 14: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Dissolved Oxygen Saturation

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend | No. of Samples | No. Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau     | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P      |
|---------------|-------------------|----------------|---------------------|------------------|---------------------|---------|---------------|-----------|--------|
| Field         | Decreasing trend  | 11226          | 31                  | 1995 - 2025      | 76                  | -0.1541 | 77.6701       | -0.2105   | 0.0001 |

Monthly average dissolved oxygen saturation decreased by 0.21% per year.

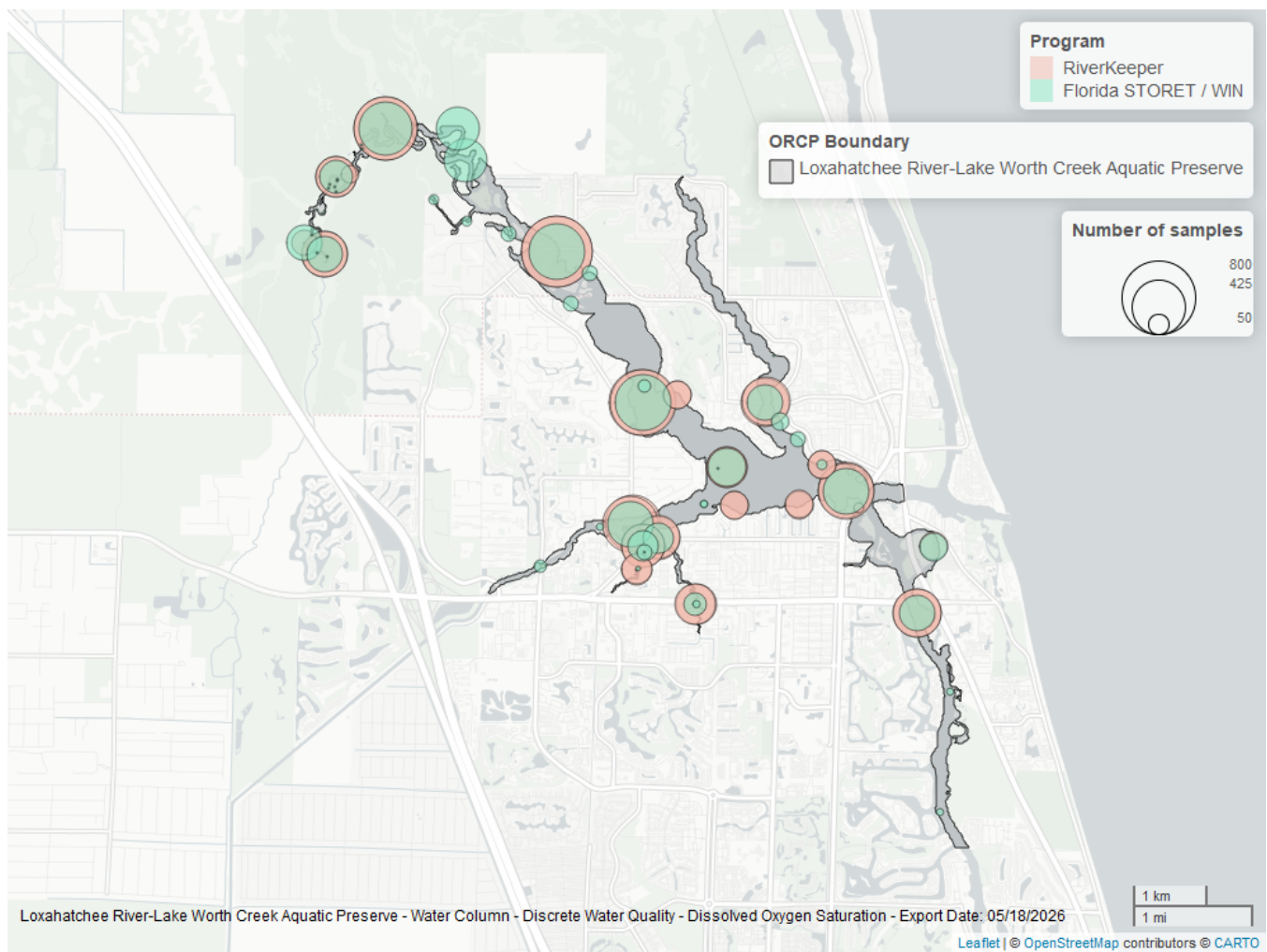


Figure 10: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 15: Programs contributing data for Dissolved Oxygen Saturation

| ProgramID | N_Data | YearMin | YearMax |
|-----------|--------|---------|---------|
| 10000     | 6348   | 1995    | 2025    |
| 5002      | 4843   | 1995    | 2025    |
| 3013      | 35     | 2014    | 2025    |

#### Program names:

10000 - RiverKeeper<sup>1</sup>

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN<sup>2</sup>

3013 - Indian River Lagoon fixed seagrass transects (SJRWMD)<sup>5</sup>

#### pH - Discrete

#### Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

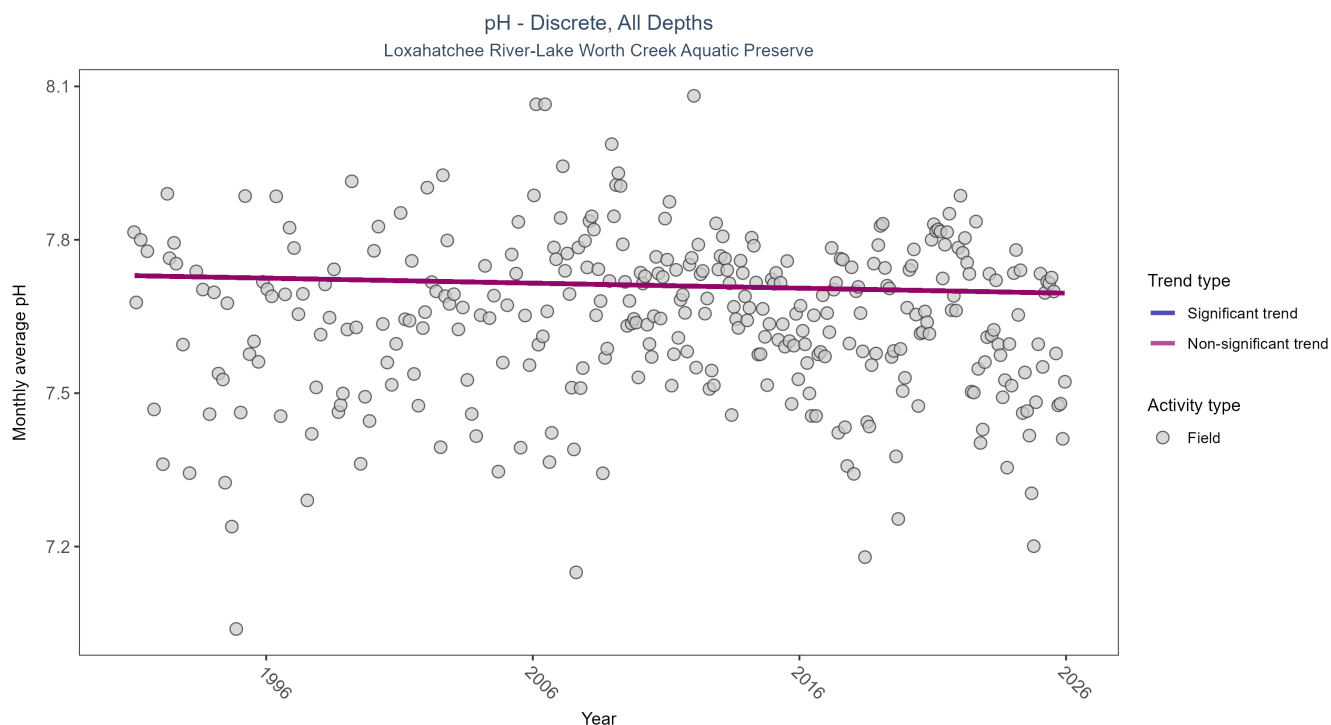


Figure 11: Scatter plot of monthly average pH over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only pH values measured in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 16: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for pH

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend   | No. of Samples | No. Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau     | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P      |
|---------------|---------------------|----------------|---------------------|------------------|---------------------|---------|---------------|-----------|--------|
| Field         | No detectable trend | 12916          | 35                  | 1991 - 2025      | 7.7                 | -0.0632 | 7.7299        | -0.001    | 0.2676 |

pH showed no detectable trend between 1991 and 2025.

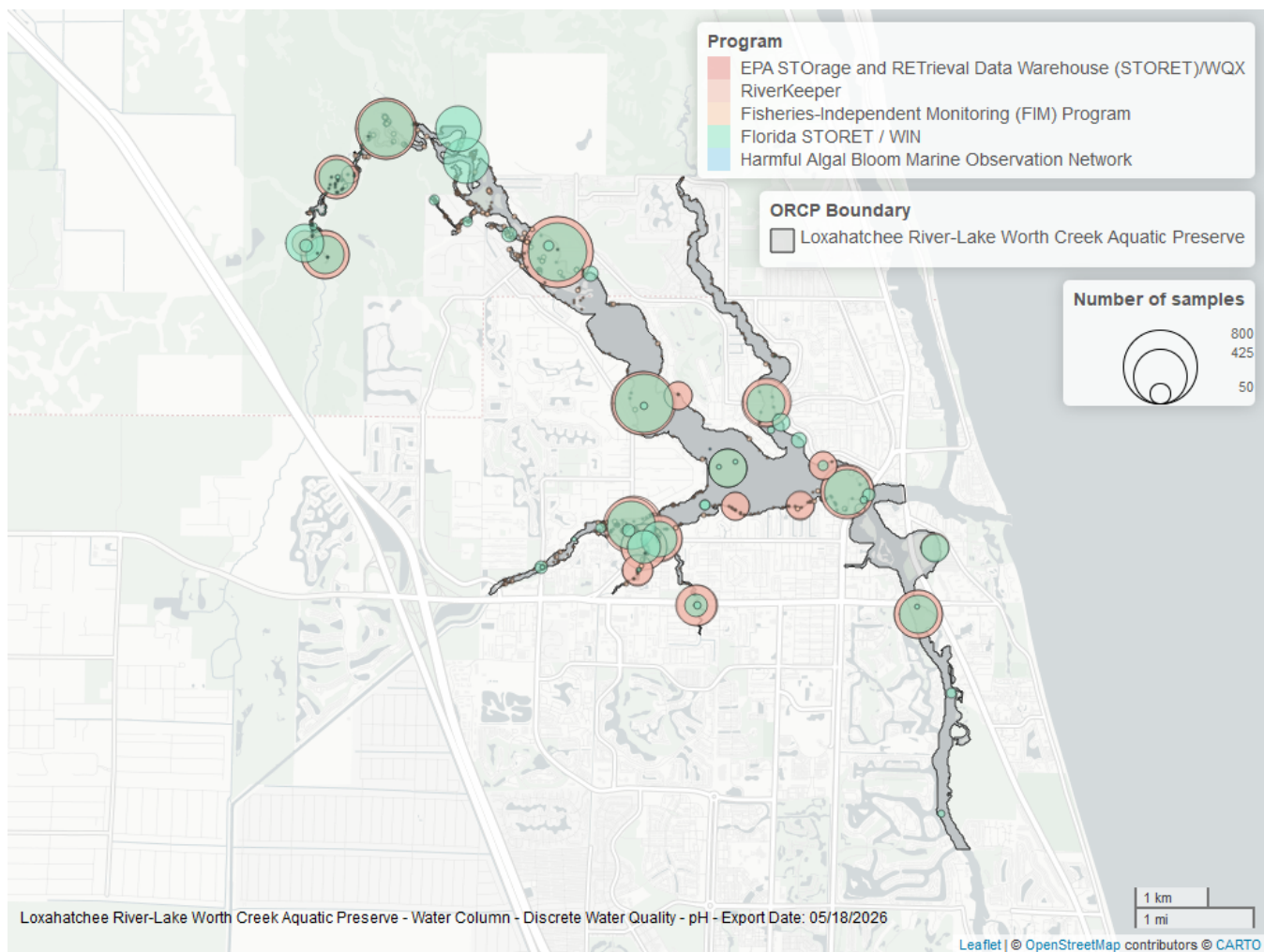


Figure 12: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 17: Programs contributing data for pH

| ProgramID | N_Data | YearMin | YearMax |
|-----------|--------|---------|---------|
| 10000     | 6426   | 1991    | 2025    |
| 5002      | 5347   | 1991    | 2025    |
| 69        | 1076   | 2014    | 2024    |
| 3013      | 63     | 2004    | 2025    |
| 103       | 3      | 2021    | 2022    |
| 95        | 2      | 2016    | 2016    |

**Program names:**

10000 - RiverKeeper<sup>1</sup>

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN<sup>2</sup>

69 - Fisheries-Independent Monitoring (FIM) Program<sup>4</sup>

3013 - Indian River Lagoon fixed seagrass transects (SJRWMD)<sup>5</sup>

103 - EPA STORage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX<sup>7</sup>

95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network<sup>6</sup>

Salinity - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

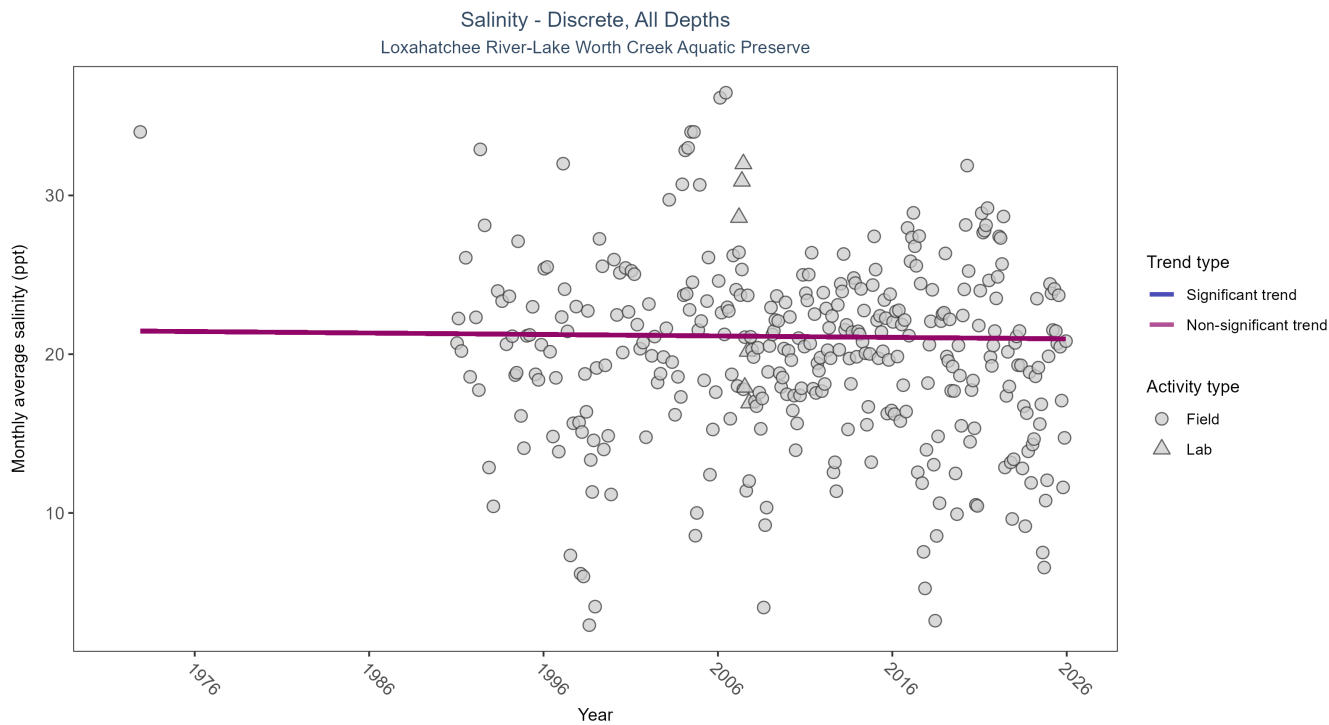


Figure 13: Scatter plot of monthly average salinity over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines are also shown. Discrete salinity values derived from grab samples analyzed in the field (circles) or the laboratory (triangles) are both included in the plot.

Table 18: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Salinity

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend   | No. of Samples | No. Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau     | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P      |
|---------------|---------------------|----------------|---------------------|------------------|---------------------|---------|---------------|-----------|--------|
| All           | No detectable trend | 12306          | 36                  | 1972 - 2025      | 24.4                | -0.0098 | 21.4632       | -0.0092   | 0.7936 |

Salinity showed no detectable trend between 1972 and 2025.



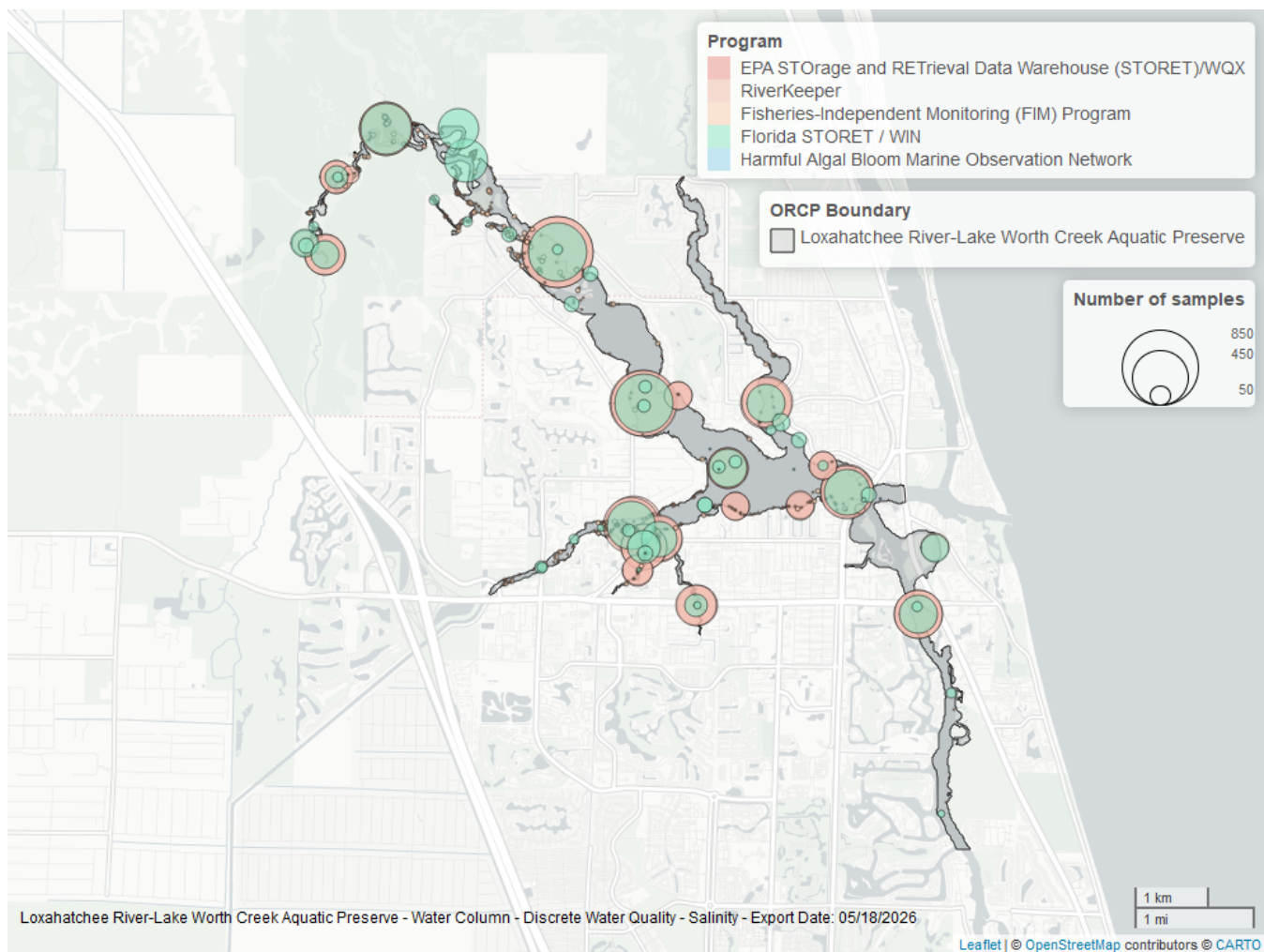


Figure 14: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 19: Programs contributing data for Salinity

| ProgramID | N_Data | YearMin | YearMax |
|-----------|--------|---------|---------|
| 10000     | 6151   | 1991    | 2025    |
| 5002      | 5000   | 1991    | 2023    |
| 69        | 1079   | 1997    | 2024    |
| 3013      | 71     | 2004    | 2025    |
| 95        | 3      | 1972    | 2016    |
| 103       | 2      | 2021    | 2022    |

**Program names:**

10000 - RiverKeeper<sup>1</sup>

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN<sup>2</sup>

69 - Fisheries-Independent Monitoring (FIM) Program<sup>4</sup>

3013 - Indian River Lagoon fixed seagrass transects (SJRWMD)<sup>5</sup>

95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network<sup>6</sup>

103 - EPA STORage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX<sup>7</sup>

## Total Nitrogen - Discrete

### Total Nitrogen Calculation:

The logic for calculated Total Nitrogen was provided by Kevin O'Donnell and colleagues at FDEP (with the help of Jay Silvanima, Watershed Monitoring Section). The following logic is used, in this order, based on the availability of specific nitrogen components.

- 1)  $TN = TKN + NO3O2$ ;
- 2)  $TN = TKN + NO3 + NO2$ ;
- 3)  $TN = ORGN + NH4 + NO3O2$ ;
- 4)  $TN = ORGN + NH4 + NO2 + NO3$ ;
- 5)  $TN = TKN + NO3$ ;
- 6)  $TN = ORGN + NH4 + NO3$ ;

### Additional Information:

- Rules for use of sample fraction:
  - Florida Department of Environmental Protection (FDEP) report that if both “Total” and “Dissolved” components are reported, only “Total” is used. If the total is not reported, then the dissolved components are used as a best available replacement.
  - Total nitrogen calculations are done using nitrogen components with the same sample fraction, nitrogen components with mixed total/dissolved sample fractions are not used. In other words, total nitrogen can be calculated when TKN and NO3O2 are both total sample fractions, or when both are dissolved sample fractions. *Future calculations of total nitrogen values may be based on components with mixed sample fractions.*
- Values inserted into data:
  - ParameterName = “Total Nitrogen”
  - SEACAR\_QAQCFlagCode = “1Q”
  - SEACAR\_QAQC\_Description = “SEACAR Calculated”



Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

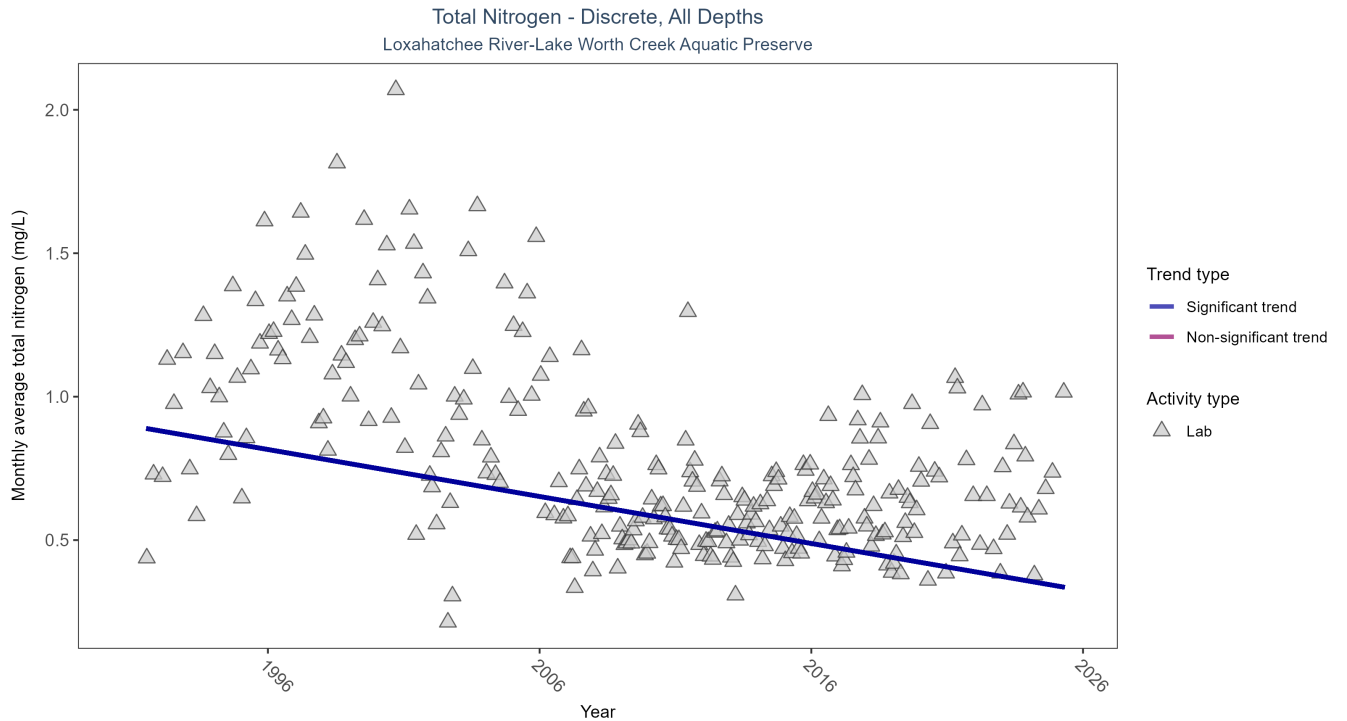


Figure 15: Scatter plot of monthly average total nitrogen over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only nitrogen values obtained from laboratory analyses (triangles) are included in the plot.

Table 20: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Total Nitrogen

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend | No. of Samples | No. Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau     | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P |
|---------------|-------------------|----------------|---------------------|------------------|---------------------|---------|---------------|-----------|---|
| Lab           | Decreasing trend  | 4773           | 35                  | 1991 - 2025      | 0.706               | -0.2676 | 0.8978        | -0.0164   | 0 |

Monthly average total nitrogen decreased by 0.02 mg/L per year.

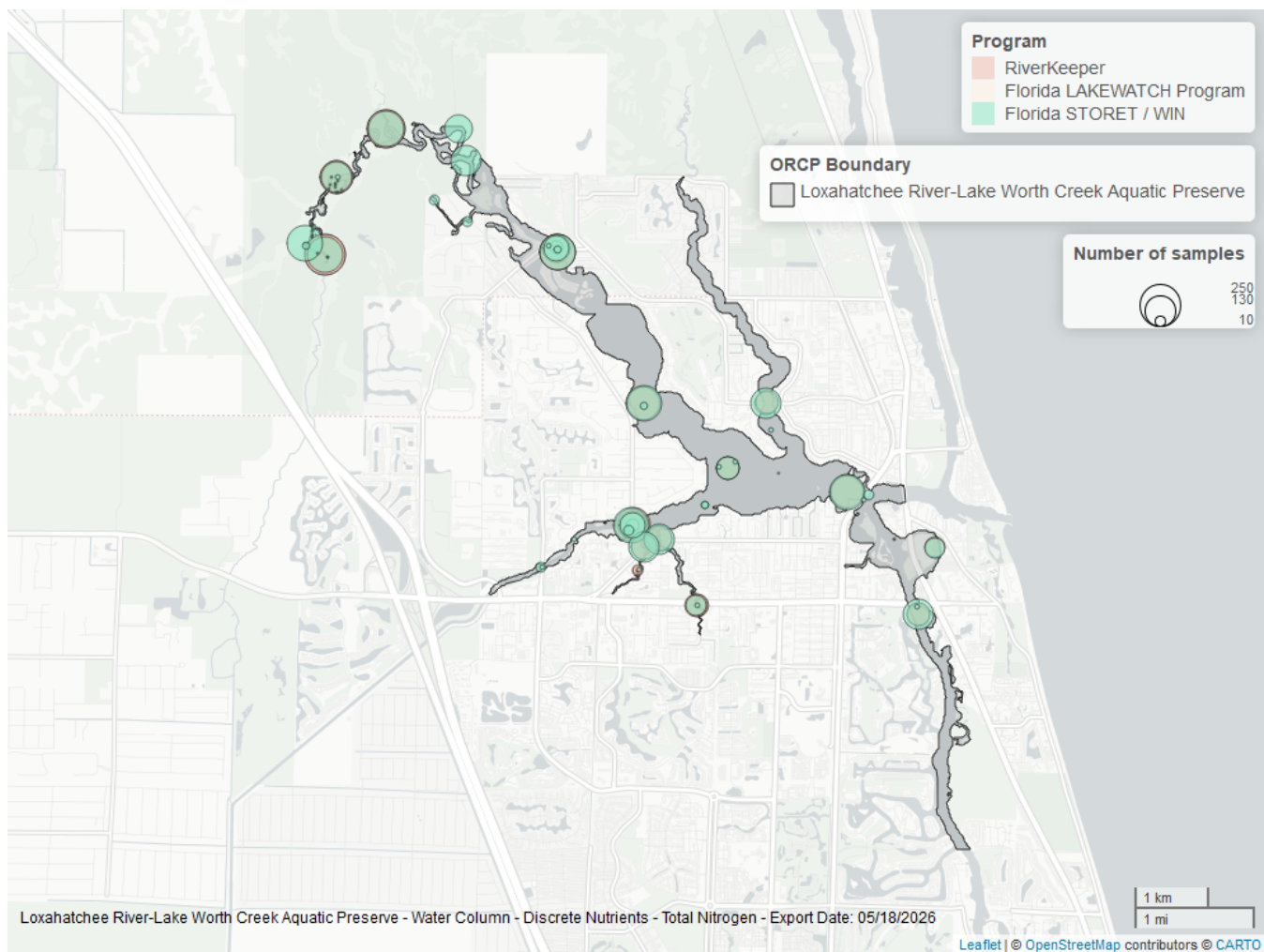


Figure 16: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 21: Programs contributing data for Total Nitrogen

| ProgramID | N_Data | YearMin | YearMax |
|-----------|--------|---------|---------|
| 5002      | 3062   | 1991    | 2025    |
| 10000     | 1993   | 1991    | 2021    |
| 514       | 304    | 2001    | 2024    |

#### Program names:

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN<sup>2</sup>

10000 - RiverKeeper<sup>1</sup>

514 - Florida LAKEWATCH Program<sup>3</sup>

#### Total Phosphorus - Discrete

#### Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

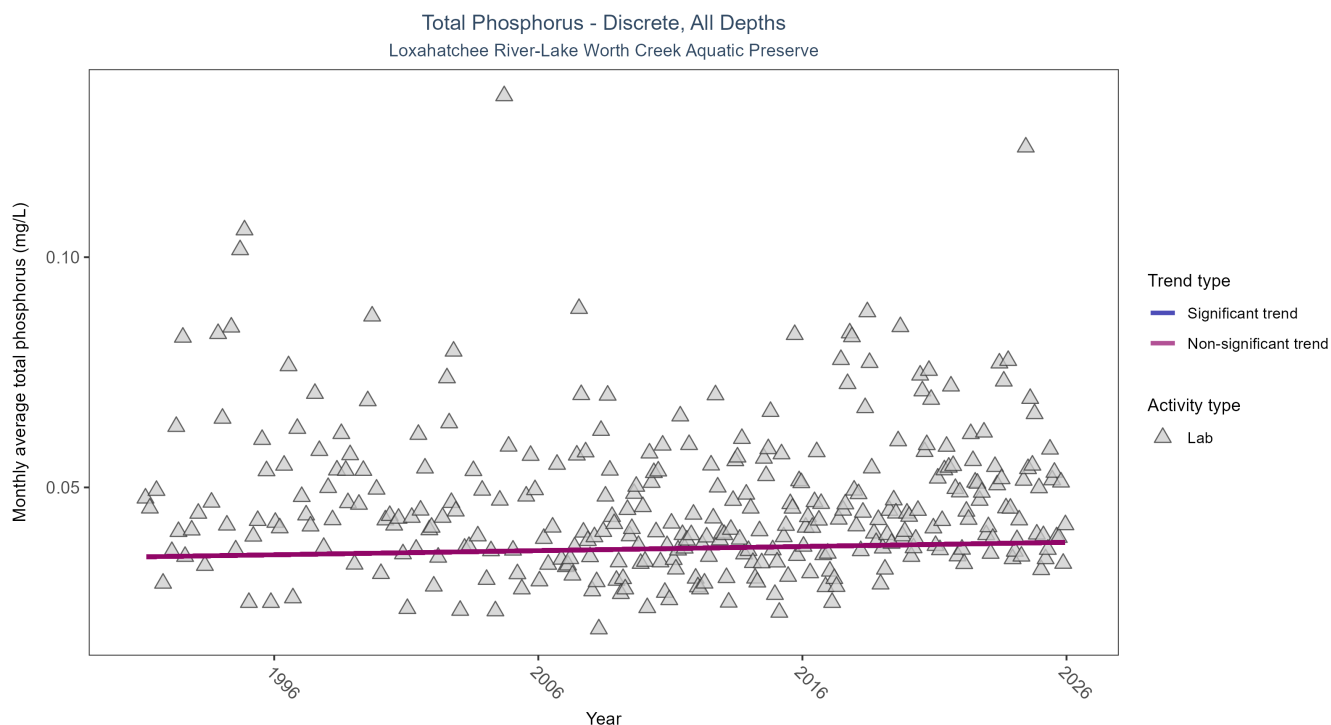


Figure 17: Scatter plot of monthly average total phosphorus over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only phosphorus values obtained from laboratory analyses (triangles) are included in the plot.

Table 22: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Total Phosphorus

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend   | No. of Samples | No. Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau    | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P      |
|---------------|---------------------|----------------|---------------------|------------------|---------------------|--------|---------------|-----------|--------|
| Lab           | No detectable trend | 6757           | 35                  | 1991 - 2025      | 0.042               | 0.0696 | 0.0349        | 0.0001    | 0.2154 |

Total phosphorus showed no detectable trend between 1991 and 2025.

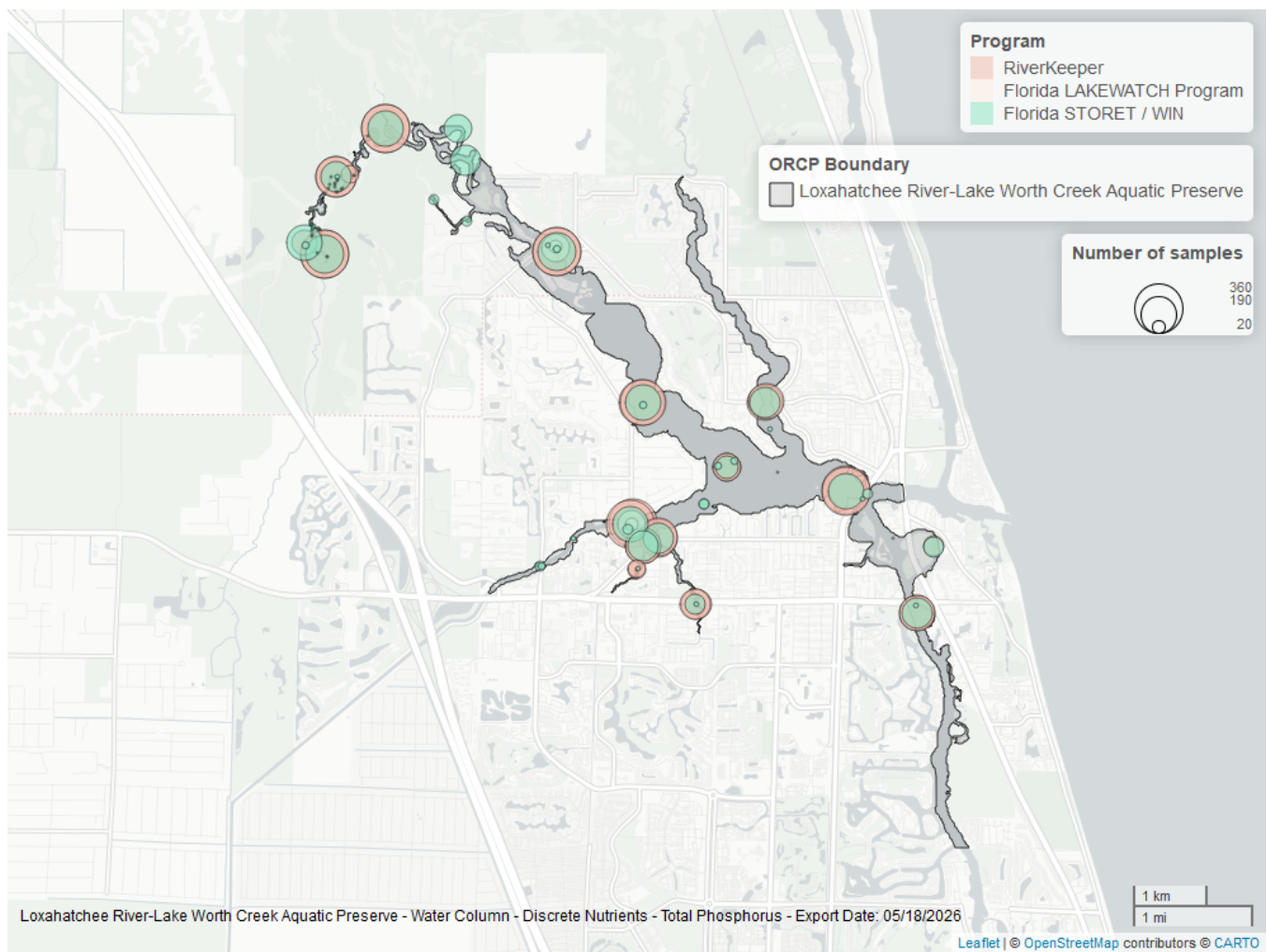


Figure 18: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 23: Programs contributing data for Total Phosphorus

| ProgramID | N_Data | YearMin | YearMax |
|-----------|--------|---------|---------|
| 10000     | 3682   | 1991    | 2025    |
| 5002      | 2915   | 1991    | 2025    |
| 514       | 306    | 2001    | 2025    |

#### Program names:

10000 - RiverKeeper<sup>1</sup>

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN<sup>2</sup>

514 - Florida LAKEWATCH Program<sup>3</sup>

#### Turbidity - Discrete

#### Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

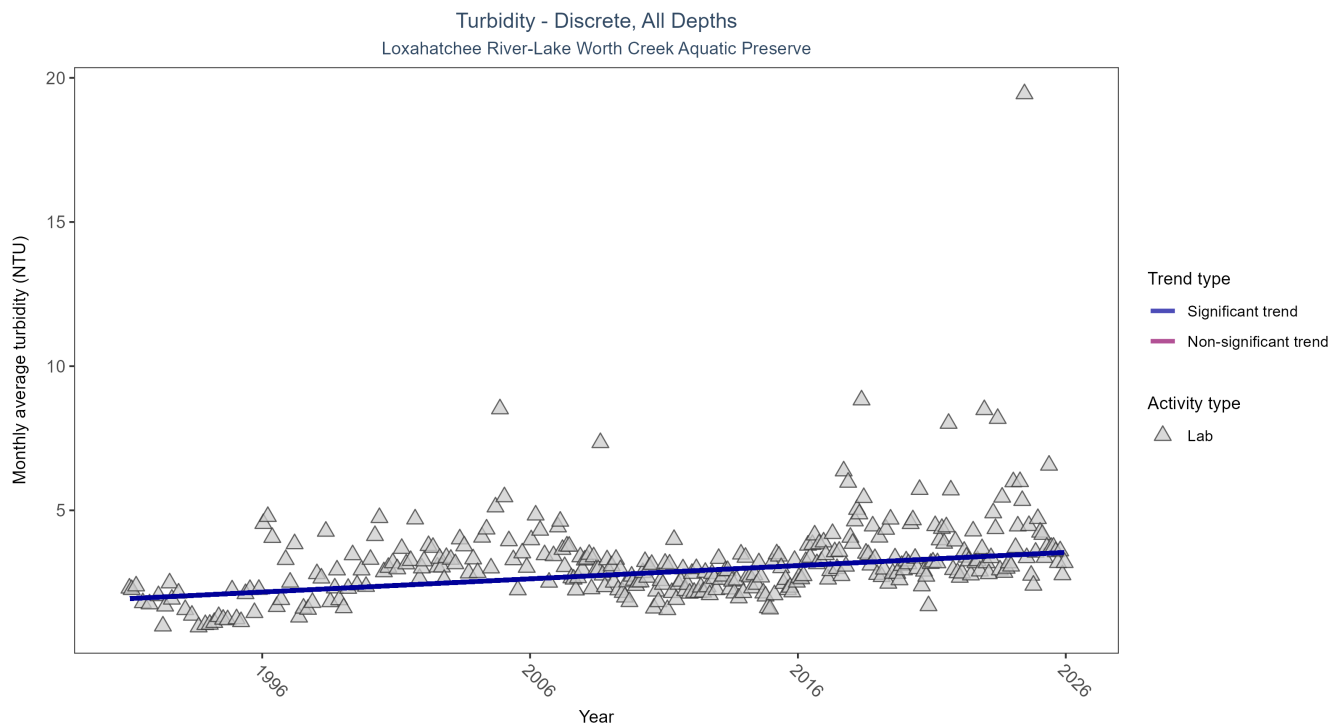


Figure 19: Scatter plot of monthly average turbidity over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only turbidity values measured in the laboratory (triangles) are included in the plot.

Table 24: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Turbidity

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend | No. of Samples | No. Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau    | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P |
|---------------|-------------------|----------------|---------------------|------------------|---------------------|--------|---------------|-----------|---|
| Lab           | Increasing trend  | 6632           | 35                  | 1991 - 2025      | 2.7                 | 0.3358 | 1.9366        | 0.0459    | 0 |

Monthly average turbidity increased by 0.05 NTU per year, indicating a decrease in water clarity.

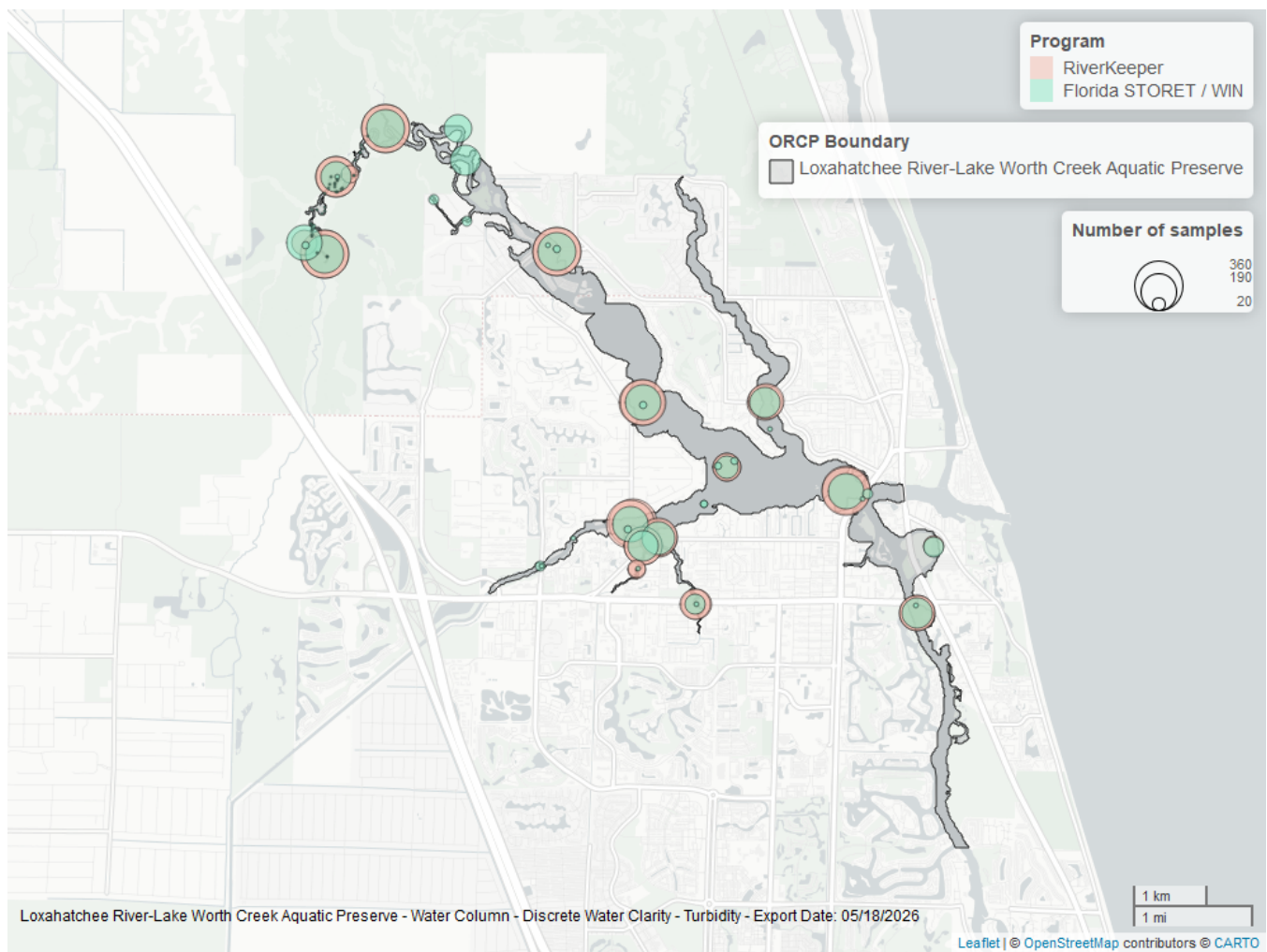


Figure 20: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 25: Programs contributing data for Turbidity

| ProgramID | N_Data | YearMin | YearMax |
|-----------|--------|---------|---------|
| 10000     | 3709   | 1991    | 2025    |
| 5002      | 2925   | 1991    | 2025    |
| 3013      | 26     | 2004    | 2018    |

#### Program names:

10000 - RiverKeeper<sup>1</sup>

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN<sup>2</sup>

3013 - Indian River Lagoon fixed seagrass transects (SJRWMD)<sup>5</sup>

#### Water Temperature - Discrete

#### Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

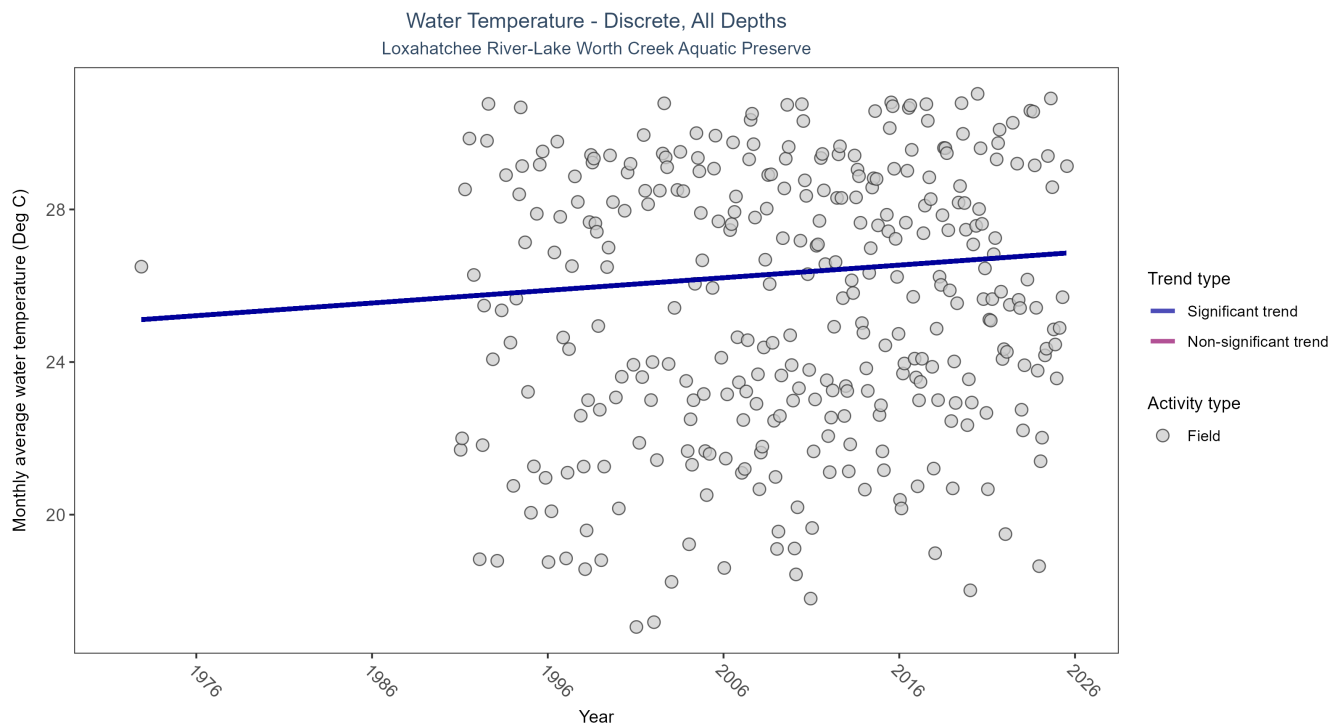


Figure 21: Scatter plot of monthly average water temperature over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only water temperature measurements taken in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 26: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Water Temperature

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend | No. of Samples | No. Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau    | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P      |
|---------------|-------------------|----------------|---------------------|------------------|---------------------|--------|---------------|-----------|--------|
| Field         | Increasing trend  | 10905          | 36                  | 1972 - 2025      | 25.6                | 0.1543 | 25.0831       | 0.0331    | 0.0001 |

Monthly average water temperature increased by  $0.03^{\circ}\text{C}$  per year.



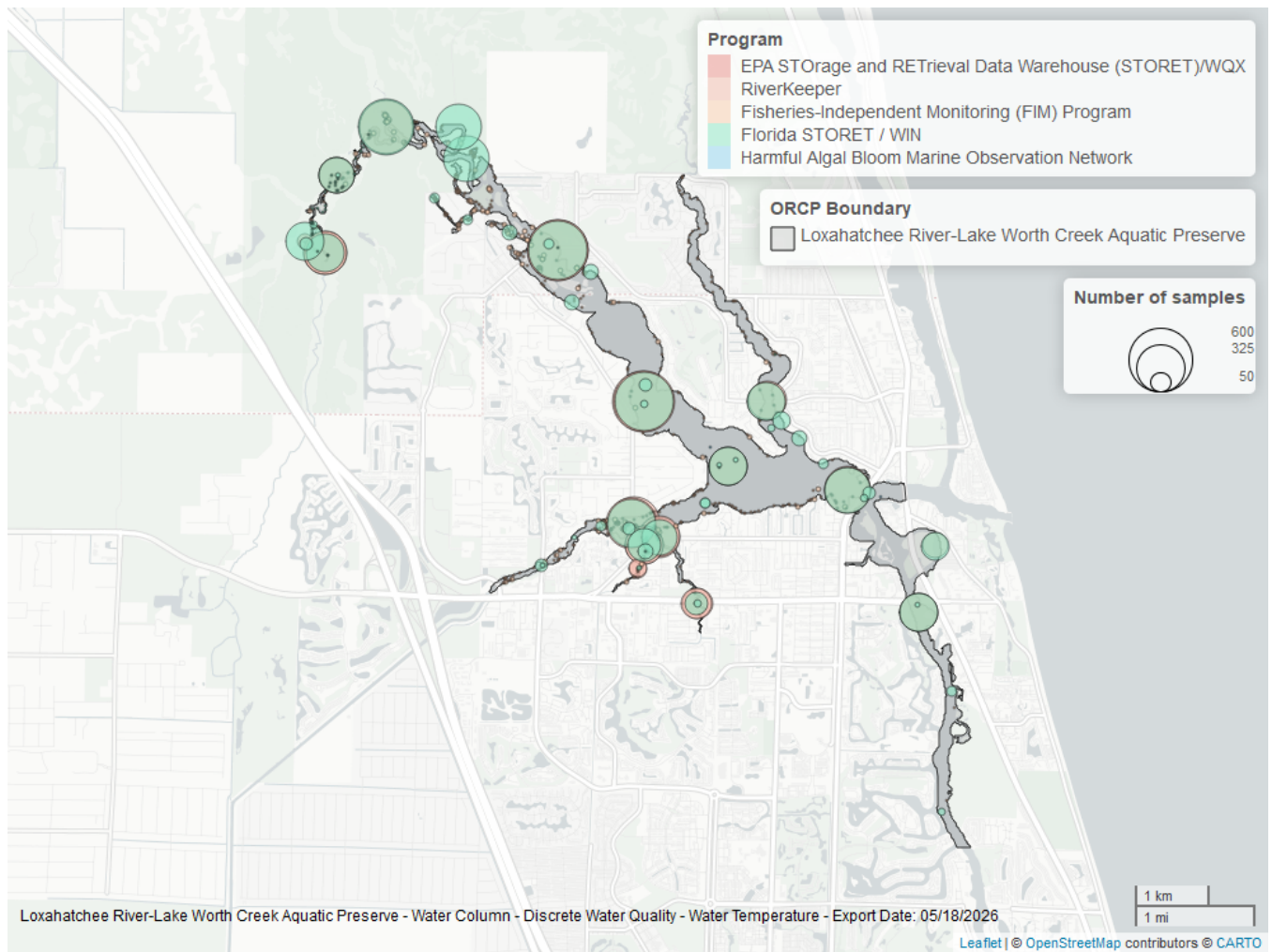


Figure 22: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 27: Programs contributing data for Water Temperature

| ProgramID | N_Data | YearMin | YearMax |
|-----------|--------|---------|---------|
| 5002      | 5436   | 1991    | 2025    |
| 10000     | 4314   | 1991    | 2019    |
| 69        | 1080   | 1997    | 2024    |
| 3013      | 70     | 2004    | 2025    |
| 95        | 3      | 1972    | 2016    |
| 103       | 2      | 2021    | 2022    |

**Program names:**

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN<sup>2</sup>

10000 - RiverKeeper<sup>1</sup>

69 - Fisheries-Independent Monitoring (FIM) Program<sup>4</sup>

3013 - Indian River Lagoon fixed seagrass transects (SJRWMD)<sup>5</sup>

95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network<sup>6</sup>

103 - EPA STOrage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX<sup>7</sup>

## Water Quality - Continuous

The following files were used in the continuous analysis:

- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_cont\_Chlorophyll\_a\_Uncorrected\_for\_Pheophytin-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_cont\_Dissolved\_Oxygen-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_cont\_Dissolved\_Oxygen\_Saturation-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_cont\_Fluorescent\_Dissolved\_Organic\_Matter-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_cont\_pH-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_cont\_Salinity-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_cont\_Specific\_Conductivity-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_cont\_Turbidity-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined\_WQ\_WC\_NUT\_cont\_Water\_Temperature-2026-Mar-06.txt*

### Continuous monitoring locations in Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve

Table 28: Station overview for Continuous parameters by Program

| <i>ProgramID</i> | <i>ProgramLocationID</i> | <i>Years of Data</i> | <i>Use in Analysis</i> | <i>Parameters</i>                                    |
|------------------|--------------------------|----------------------|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| 7                | 02277743                 | 3                    | FALSE                  | Water Temperature , Salinity , Specific Conductivity |
| 7                | 265645080055900          | 5                    | TRUE                   | Water Temperature, Salinity                          |
| 7                | 265656080063500          | 5                    | TRUE                   | Water Temperature , Salinity , Specific Conductivity |
| 7                | 265906080093500          | 21                   | TRUE                   | Specific Conductivity                                |
| 7                | 265906080093500          | 24                   | TRUE                   | Water Temperature, Salinity                          |
| 7                | 265929080091800          | 21                   | TRUE                   | Specific Conductivity                                |
| 7                | 265929080091800          | 25                   | TRUE                   | Water Temperature, Salinity                          |

#### Program names:

7 - National Water Information System<sup>8</sup>

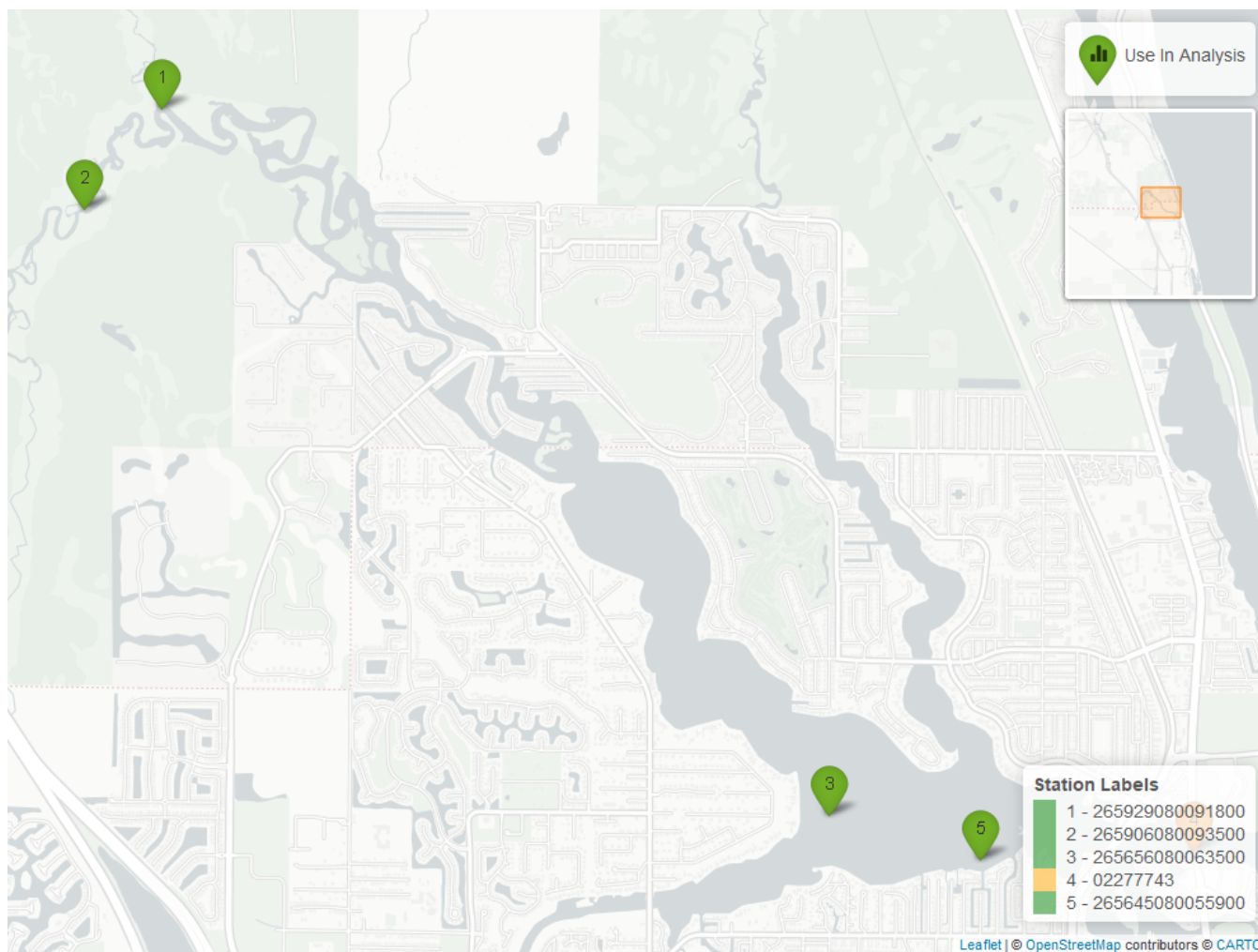


Figure 23: Map showing continuous water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve*. Sites marked as *Use In Analysis* (green) are featured in this report.

## Water Temperature - Continuous

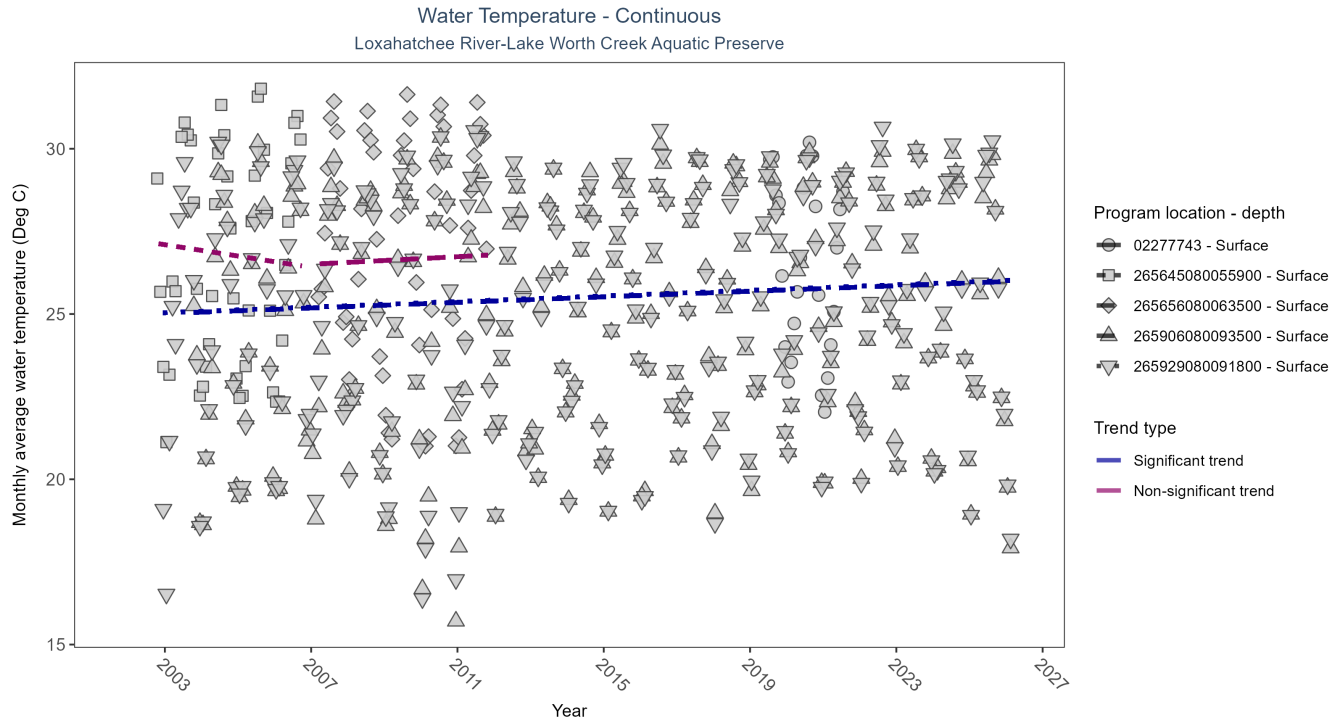


Figure 24: Scatter plot of monthly average water temperature over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 29: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Water Temperature - All Stations

| Program Location | Statistical Trend                    | No. of Samples | No. Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau   | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P    |
|------------------|--------------------------------------|----------------|---------------------|------------------|---------------------|-------|---------------|-----------|------|
| 02277743         | Insufficient data to calculate trend | 1122           | 3                   | 2019 - 2021      | 26.3                | -     | -             | -         | -    |
| 265645080055900  | No significant trend                 | 1354           | 5                   | 2002 - 2006      | 26.6                | -0.29 | 27.27         | -0.17     | 0.07 |
| 265656080063500  | No significant trend                 | 2664           | 5                   | 2007 - 2011      | 27.6                | 0.08  | 26.5          | 0.06      | 0.45 |
| 265906080093500  | Significantly increasing trend       | 12641          | 24                  | 2003 - 2026      | 25.6                | 0.27  | 25.01         | 0.04      | 0    |
| 265929080091800  | Significantly increasing trend       | 8297           | 25                  | 2002 - 2026      | 25.7                | 0.23  | 25            | 0.04      | 0    |

At two program locations, monthly average water temperature increased by 0.04°C per year. No detectable change in monthly average water temperature was observed at two locations. There was insufficient data to fit a model for one location.

Salinity - Continuous

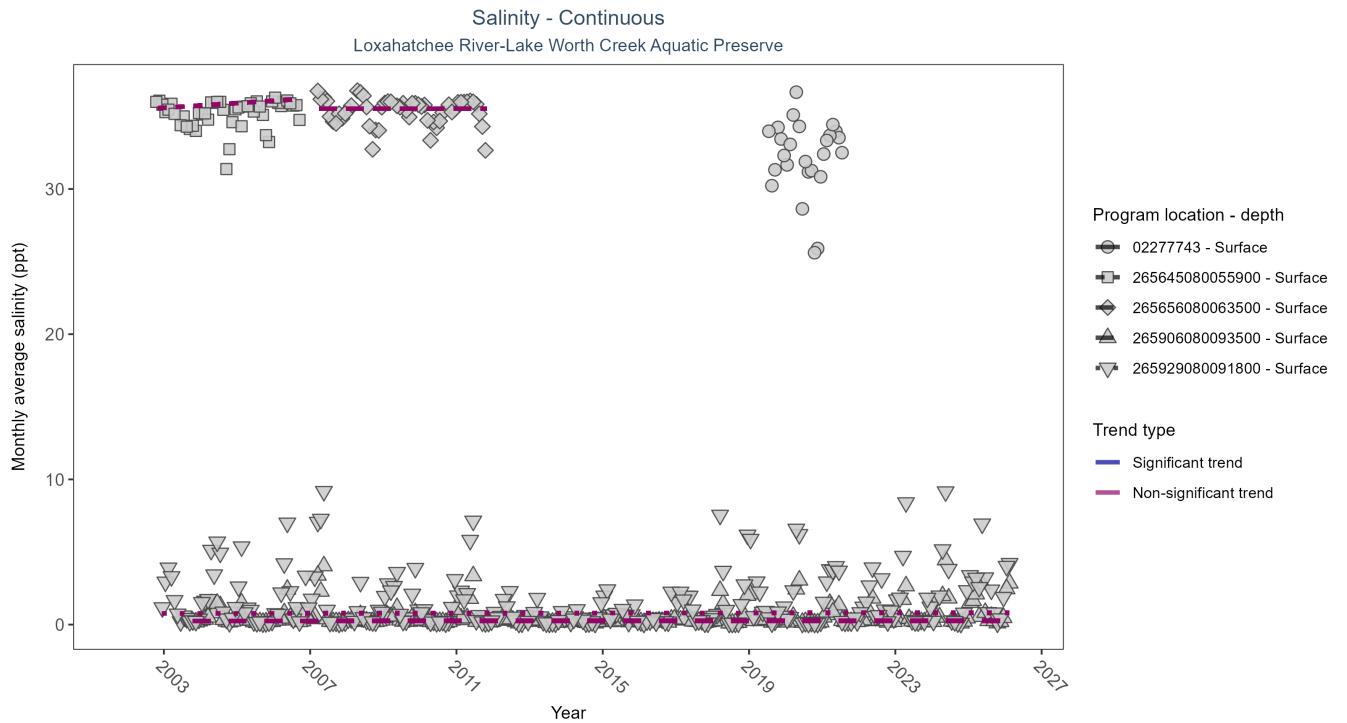


Figure 25: Scatter plot of monthly average salinity over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 30: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Salinity - All Stations

| Program Location | Statistical Trend                    | No. of Samples | No. Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau  | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P    |
|------------------|--------------------------------------|----------------|---------------------|------------------|---------------------|------|---------------|-----------|------|
| 02277743         | Insufficient data to calculate trend | 1144           | 3                   | 2019 - 2021      | 32.0                | -    | -             | -         | -    |
| 265645080055900  | No significant trend                 | 1354           | 5                   | 2002 - 2006      | 36.0                | 0.22 | 35.43         | 0.16      | 0.16 |
| 265656080063500  | No significant trend                 | 2046           | 5                   | 2007 - 2011      | 36.0                | 0.01 | 35.53         | 0         | 1    |
| 265906080093500  | No significant trend                 | 9559           | 24                  | 2003 - 2026      | 0.3                 | 0.05 | 0.25          | 0         | 0.26 |
| 265929080091800  | No significant trend                 | 8275           | 25                  | 2002 - 2026      | 0.4                 | 0.04 | 0.76          | 0         | 0.39 |

No detectable change in monthly average salinity was observed at four locations. There was insufficient data to fit a model for one location.

Specific Conductivity - Continuous

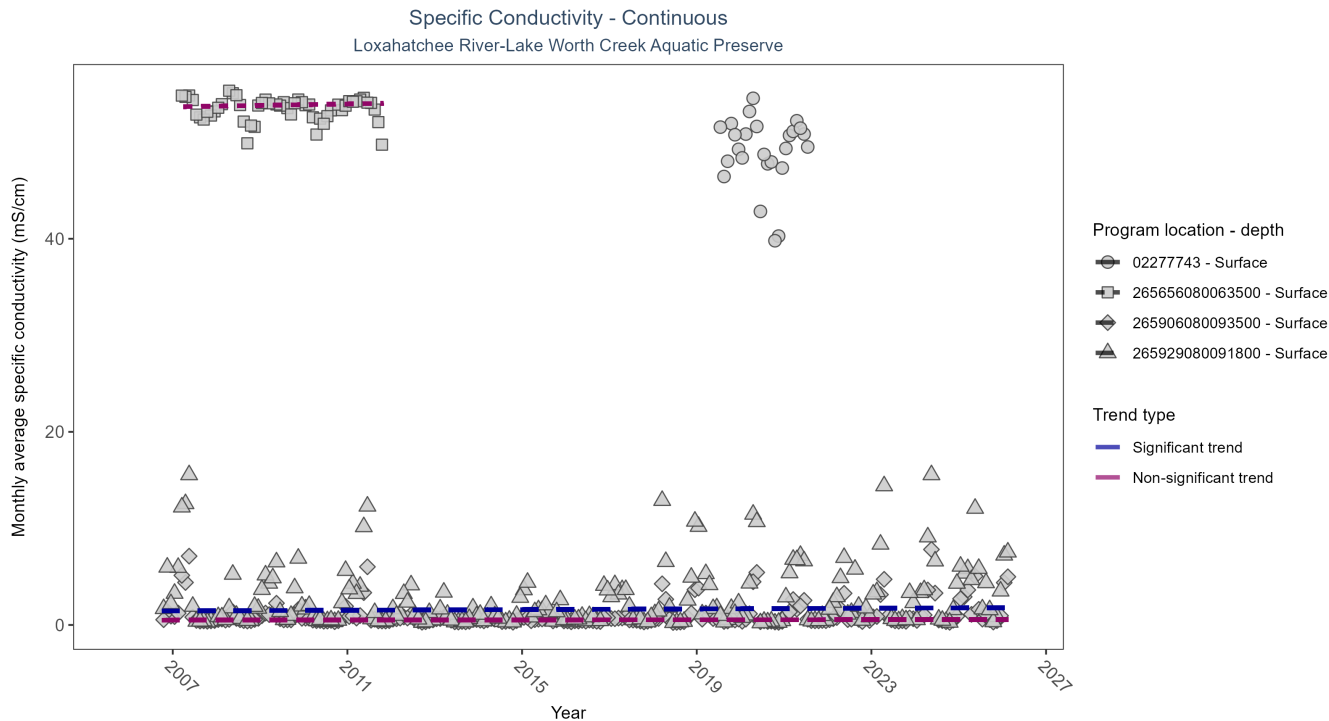


Figure 26: Scatter plot of monthly average specific conductivity over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 31: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Specific Conductivity - All Stations

| Program Location | Statistical Trend                    | No. of Samples | No. Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau  | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P    |
|------------------|--------------------------------------|----------------|---------------------|------------------|---------------------|------|---------------|-----------|------|
| 02277743         | Insufficient data to calculate trend | 1425           | 3                   | 2019 - 2021      | 50.10               | -    | -             | -         | -    |
| 265656080063500  | No significant trend                 | 2550           | 5                   | 2007 - 2011      | 53.90               | 0.04 | 53.66         | 0.08      | 0.93 |
| 265906080093500  | No significant trend                 | 13578          | 21                  | 2006 - 2026      | 0.56                | 0.07 | 0.5           | 0         | 0.17 |
| 265929080091800  | Significantly increasing trend       | 6830           | 21                  | 2006 - 2026      | 0.82                | 0.11 | 1.43          | 0.02      | 0.03 |

At one program location, monthly average specific conductivity increased by 0.02 mS/cm per year. No detectable change in monthly average specific conductivity was observed at two locations. There was insufficient data to fit a model for one location.

# Submerged Aquatic Vegetation

The data file used is: **All\_SAV\_Parameters-2026-Jun-04.txt**

**Submerged aquatic vegetation (SAV)** refers to plants and plant-like macroalgae species that live entirely underwater. The two primary categories of SAV inhabiting Florida estuaries are *benthic macroalgae* and *seagrasses*. They often grow together in dense beds or meadows that carpet the seafloor. *Macroalgae* include multicellular species of green, red and brown algae that often live attached to the substrate by a holdfast. They tend to grow quickly and can tolerate relatively high nutrient levels, making them a threat to seagrasses and other benthic habitats in areas with poor water quality. In contrast, *seagrasses* are grass-like, vascular, flowering plants that are attached to the seafloor by extensive root systems. *Seagrasses* occur throughout the coastal areas of Florida, including protected bays and lagoons as well as deeper offshore waters on the continental shelf. *Seagrasses* have taken advantage of the broad, shallow shelf and clear water to produce two of the most extensive seagrass beds anywhere in continental North America.

## Parameters

**Percent Cover** measures the fraction of an area of seafloor that is covered by SAV, usually estimated by evaluating multiple small areas of seafloor. Percent cover is often estimated for total SAV, individual types of vegetation (seagrass, attached algae, drift algae) and individual species.

**Frequency of Occurrence** was calculated as the number of times a taxon was observed in a year divided by the number of sampling events, multiplied by 100. Analysis is conducted at the quadrat level and is inclusive of all quadrats (i.e., quadrats evaluated using Braun-Blanquet, modified Braun-Blanquet, and percent cover.”

## Species

**Turtle grass** (*Thalassia testudinum*) is the largest of the Florida seagrasses, with longer, thicker blades and deeper root structures than any of the other seagrasses. It is considered a climax seagrass species.

**Shoal grass** (*Halodule wrightii*) is an early colonizer of vegetated areas and usually grows in water too shallow for other species except *widgeon grass*. It can often tolerate larger salinity ranges than other seagrass species. *Shoal grass* is characterized by thin, flat blades, that are narrower than *turtle grass* blades.

**Manatee grass** (*Syringodium filiforme*) is easily recognizable because its leaves are thin and cylindrical instead of the flat, ribbon-like form shared by many other seagrass species. The leaves can grow up to half a meter in length. *Manatee grass* is usually found in mixed seagrass beds or small, dense monospecific patches.

**Widgeon grass** (*Ruppia maritima*) grows in both fresh and salt water and is widely distributed throughout Florida's estuaries in less saline areas, particularly in inlets along the east coast. This species resembles *shoal grass* in certain environments but can be identified by the pointed tips of its leaves.

Three species of *Halophila* spp. are found in Florida - **Star grass** (*Halophila engelmannii*), **Paddle grass** (*Halophila decipiens*), and **Johnson's seagrass** (*Halophila johnsonii*). These are smaller, more fragile seagrasses than other Florida species and are considered ephemeral. They grow along a single long rhizome, with short blades. These species are not well-studied, although surveys are underway to define their ecological roles.

## Notes

*Star grass*, *Paddle grass*, and *Johnson's seagrass* will be grouped together and listed as **Halophila spp.** in the following managed areas. This is because several surveys did not specify to the species level:

- Banana River Aquatic Preserve
- Indian River-Malabar to Vero Beach Aquatic Preserve
- Indian River-Vero Beach to Ft. Pierce Aquatic Preserve
- Jensen Beach to Jupiter Inlet Aquatic Preserve
- Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve
- Mosquito Lagoon Aquatic Preserve



- Biscayne Bay Aquatic Preserve
- Florida Keys National Marine Sanctuary

Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve  
SAV Percent Cover - Sample Locations



Figure 27: Maps showing the temporal scope of SAV sampling sites within the boundaries of *Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve* by program name.

Click [here](#) to view spatio-temporal plots on GitHub.

### Sampling locations by Program:

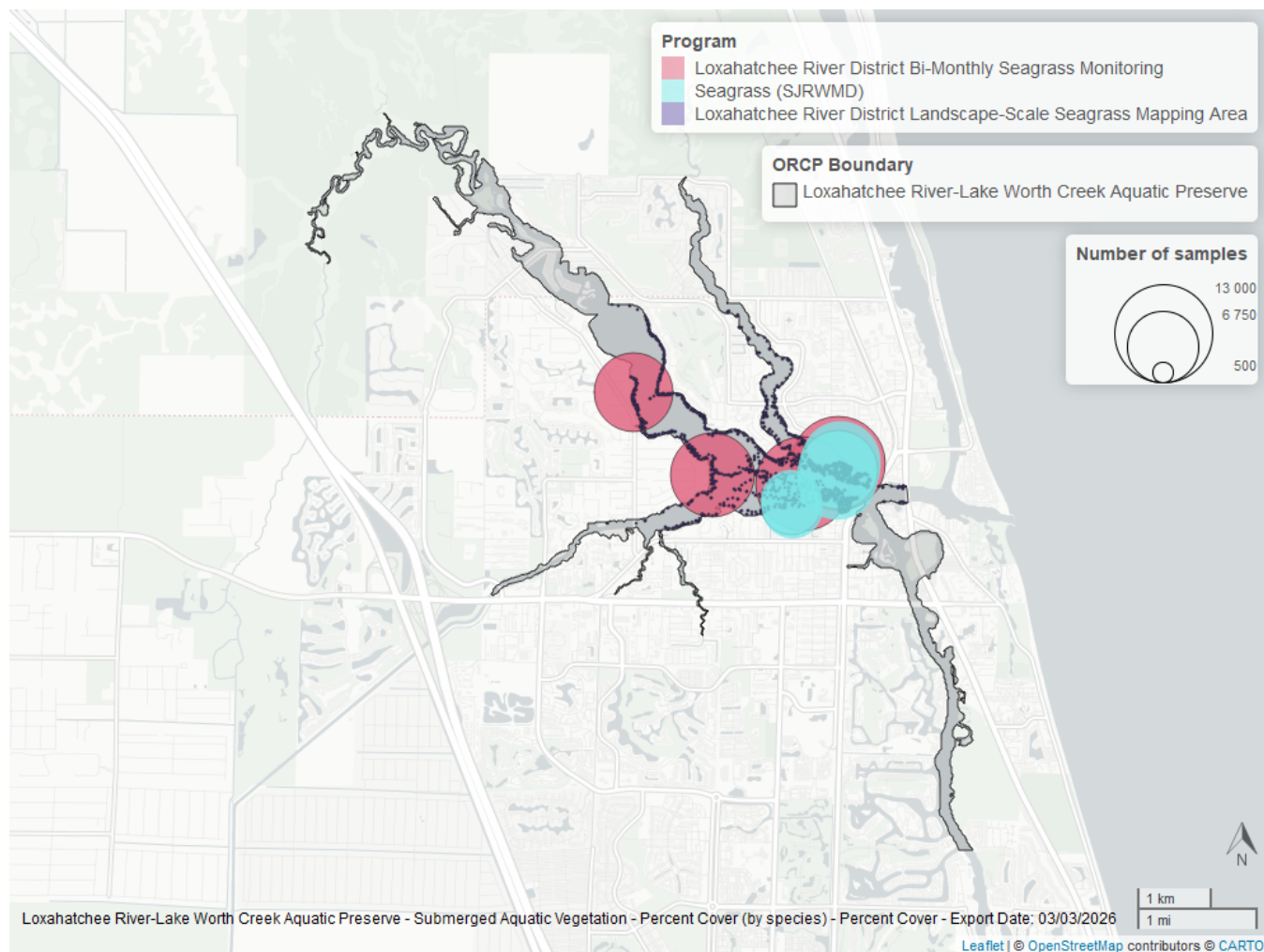


Figure 28: Map showing SAV sampling sites within the boundaries of *Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve*. The point size reflects the number of samples at a given sampling site.

Table 32: Program Information for Submerged Aquatic Vegetation

| <i>ProgramID</i> | <i>N-Data</i> | <i>YearMin</i> | <i>YearMax</i> | <i>method</i>      | <i>Sample Locations</i> |
|------------------|---------------|----------------|----------------|--------------------|-------------------------|
| 3013             | 6653          | 1999           | 2025           | Percent Cover      | 2                       |
| 3013             | 7368          | 1999           | 2025           | Percent Occurrence | 2                       |
| 3017             | 43372         | 2007           | 2025           | Percent Occurrence | 4                       |
| 10001            | 9672          | 2007           | 2007           | Percent Occurrence | 1612                    |

### Program names:

3013 - Seagrass (SJRWMD)<sup>5</sup>

3017 - Loxahatchee River District Bi-Monthly Seagrass Monitoring<sup>9</sup>

10001 - Loxahatchee River District Landscape-Scale Seagrass Mapping Area<sup>10</sup>

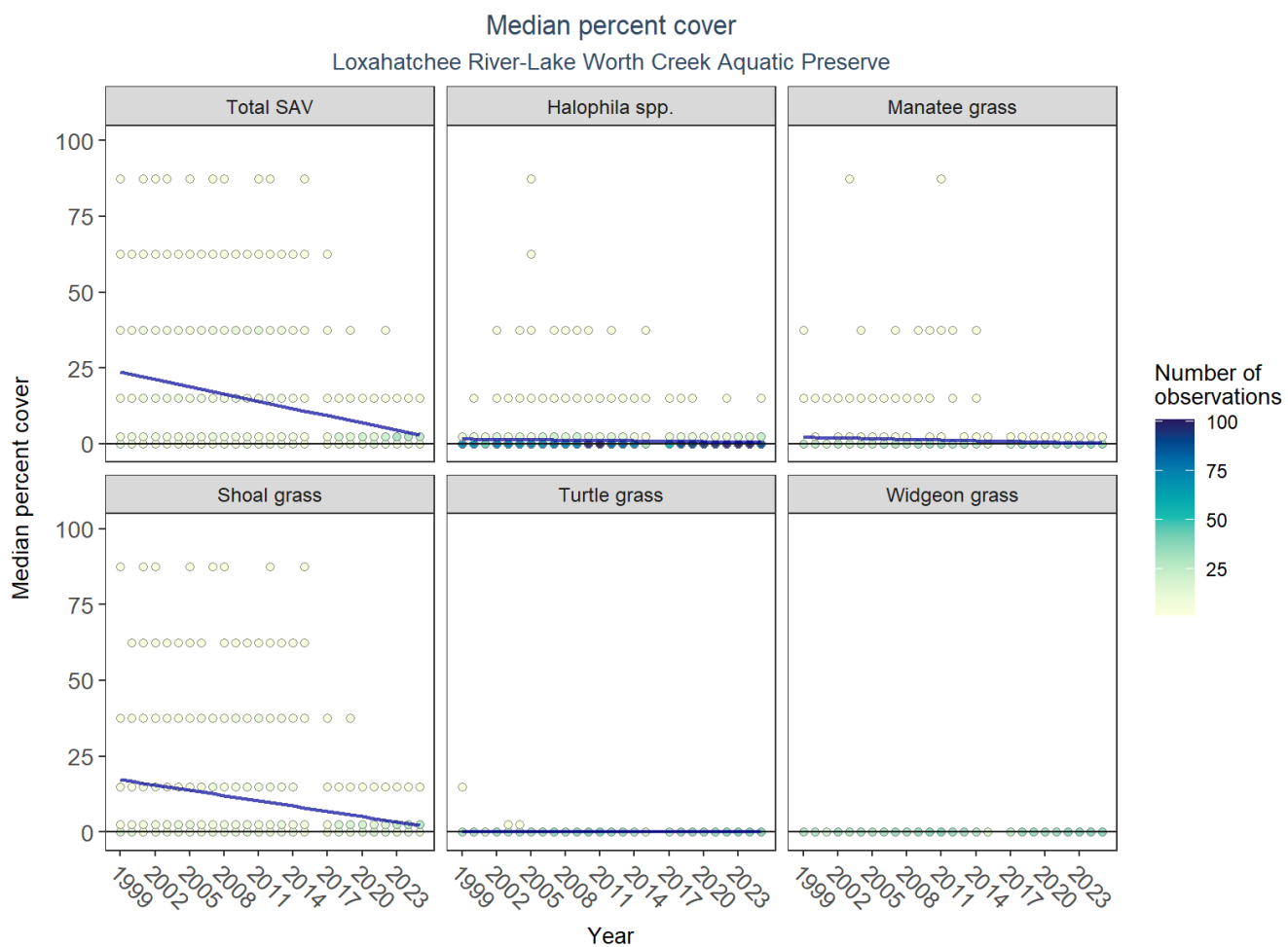


Figure 29: Scatter plots of median percent cover of submerged aquatic vegetation over time by group. Plots for time series that included five or more years of observations show the estimated trend as a blue line.

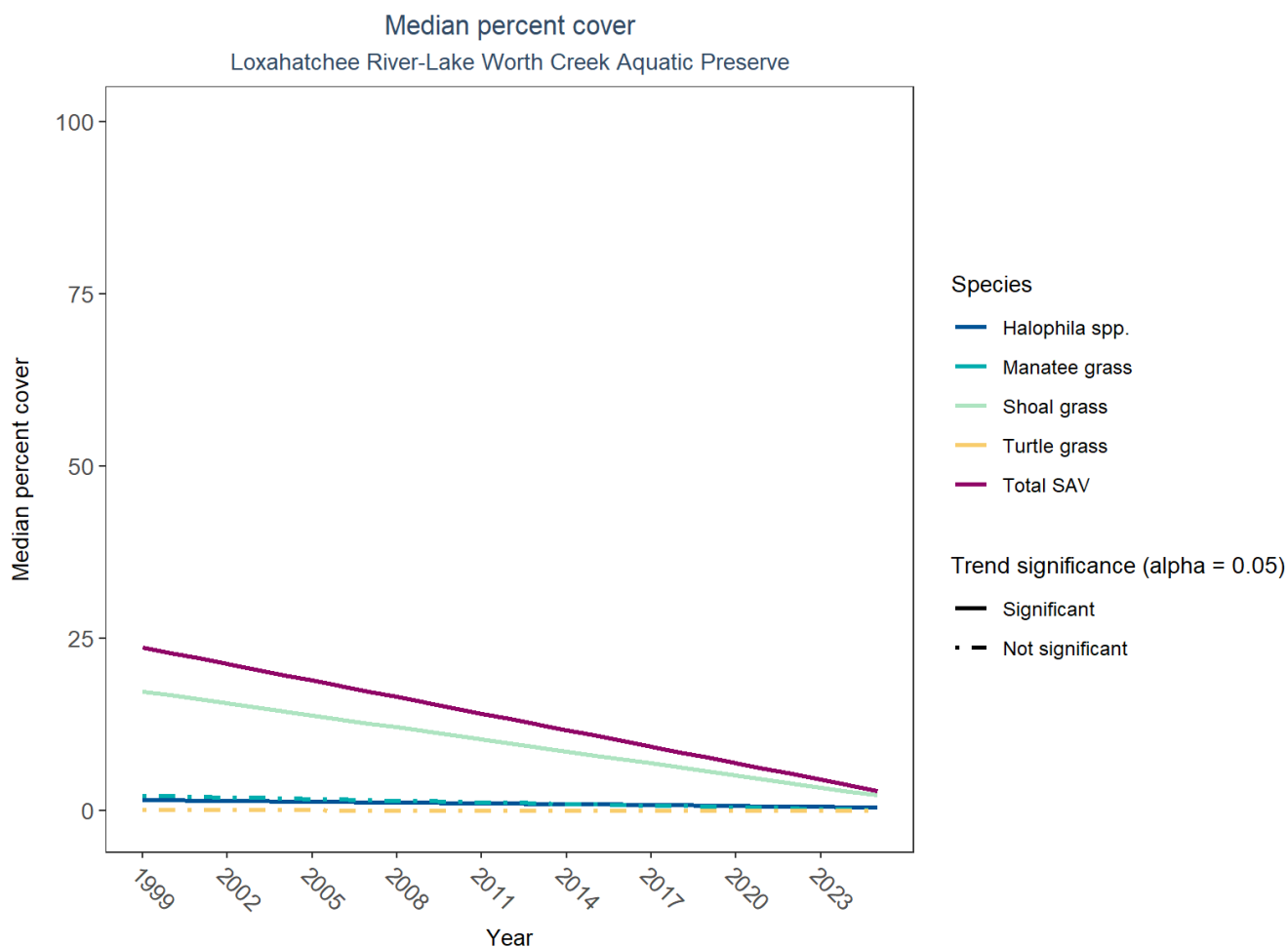


Figure 30: Trend lines of median percent cover of submerged aquatic vegetation over time for species that had five or more years of observations. Line type represents significance (solid) or non-significance (dashed) of the trends.

Table 33: Percent Cover Trend Analysis for Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve

| <i>Species</i> | <i>Statistical Trend</i>             | <i>Period of Record</i> | <i>LME Intercept</i> | <i>LME Slope</i> | <i>P</i>  |
|----------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------|------------------|-----------|
| Shoal grass    | Decreasing trend                     | 1999 - 2025             | 20.1953417           | -0.5806452       | 0.0000000 |
| Halophila spp. | Decreasing trend                     | 1999 - 2025             | 1.7148599            | -0.0397868       | 0.0005251 |
| Widgeon grass  | Model did not fit the available data | 1999 - 2025             | -                    | -                | -         |
| Manatee grass  | No detectable trend                  | 1999 - 2025             | 2.5395157            | -0.0779051       | 0.3363388 |
| Turtle grass   | No detectable trend                  | 1999 - 2025             | 0.0937988            | -0.0040048       | 0.3007476 |
| Total SAV      | Decreasing trend                     | 1999 - 2025             | 27.6619616           | -0.7987412       | 0.0000000 |

Annual decreases in percent cover were observed for total SAV (-0.80%), Halophila spp. (-0.04%), and shoal grass (-0.58%). No detectable change in percent cover was observed for manatee grass and turtle grass. The model could not be fitted for widgeon grass.

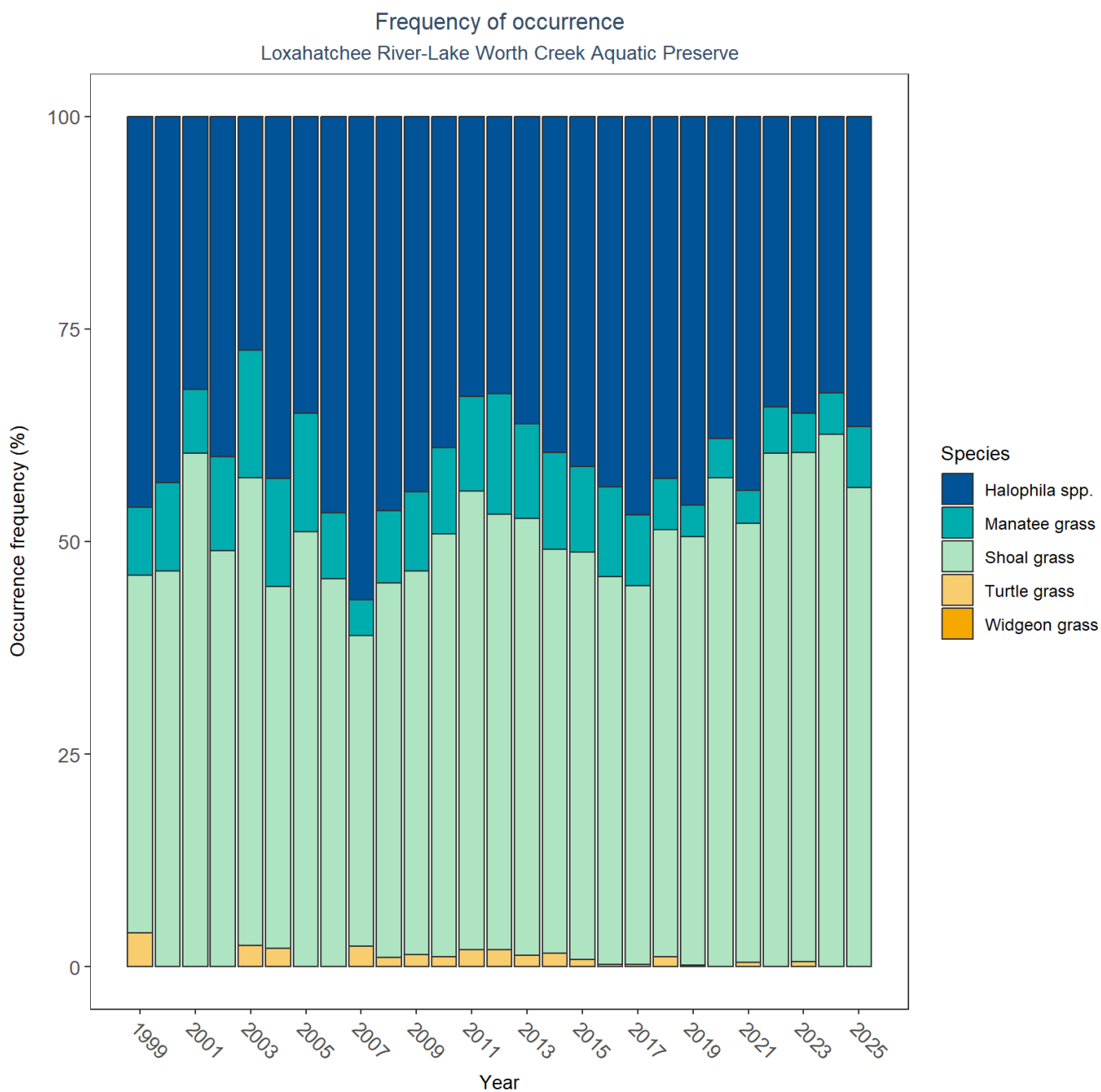


Figure 31: Bar plot of submerged aquatic vegetation species occurrence frequency over time by group.

### SAV Water Column Analysis

The following parameters are available for Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve within the SAV\_WC\_Report:

- Colored Dissolved Organic Matter
- Chlorophyll a
- Dissolved Oxygen
- Dissolved Oxygen Saturation
- pH

- Salinity
- Secchi Depth
- Water Temperature
- Total Nitrogen
- Total Suspended Solids
- Turbidity

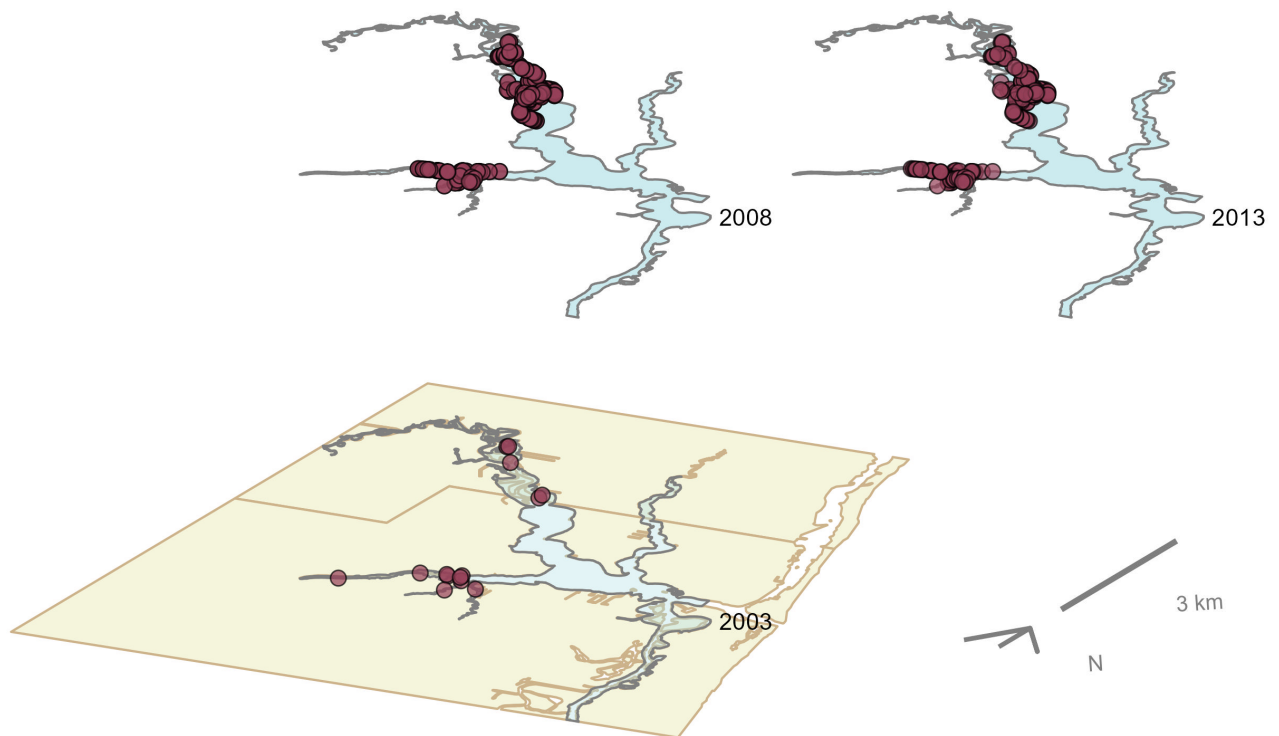
Access the reports here: [DRAFT\\_SAV\\_WC\\_Report.pdf](#)

## Oyster

The data file used is: **All\_OYSTER\_Parameters-2026-Jun-04.txt**

## Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve

Oyster sample locations available in SEACAR by Program and Year



Program name

- Loxahatchee River Oyster Mapping and Recruitment

Figure 32: Maps showing the temporal scope of oyster sampling sites within the boundaries of *Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve* by program name.



Click [here](#) to view spatio-temporal plots on GitHub.

Density

For natural reefs, there was insufficient data to calculate a trend for density.

Natural

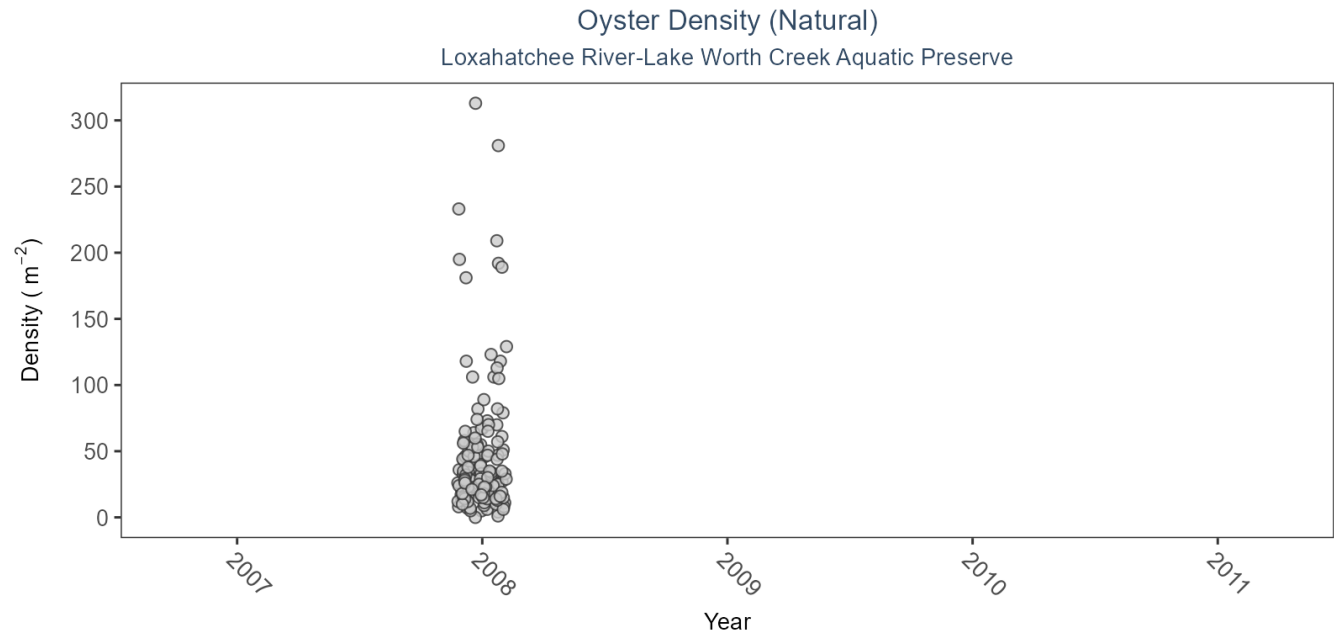


Figure 33: Scatter plot of oyster density over time. If the time series included five or more years with observations, an estimated trend (blue line) and a 95% credible interval (purple band) may also be plotted. Data points are jittered horizontally to reduce overlap.

Table 34: Model results for Oyster Density - Natural

| <i>Habitat Type</i> | <i>Shell Type</i> | <i>Statistical Trend</i> | <i>Period of Record</i> | <i>Estimate</i> | <i>Standard Error</i> | <i>Credible Interval</i> |
|---------------------|-------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------|-----------------|-----------------------|--------------------------|
| Natural             | Live Oysters      | Insufficient data        | 2008 - 2008             | -               | -                     | -                        |

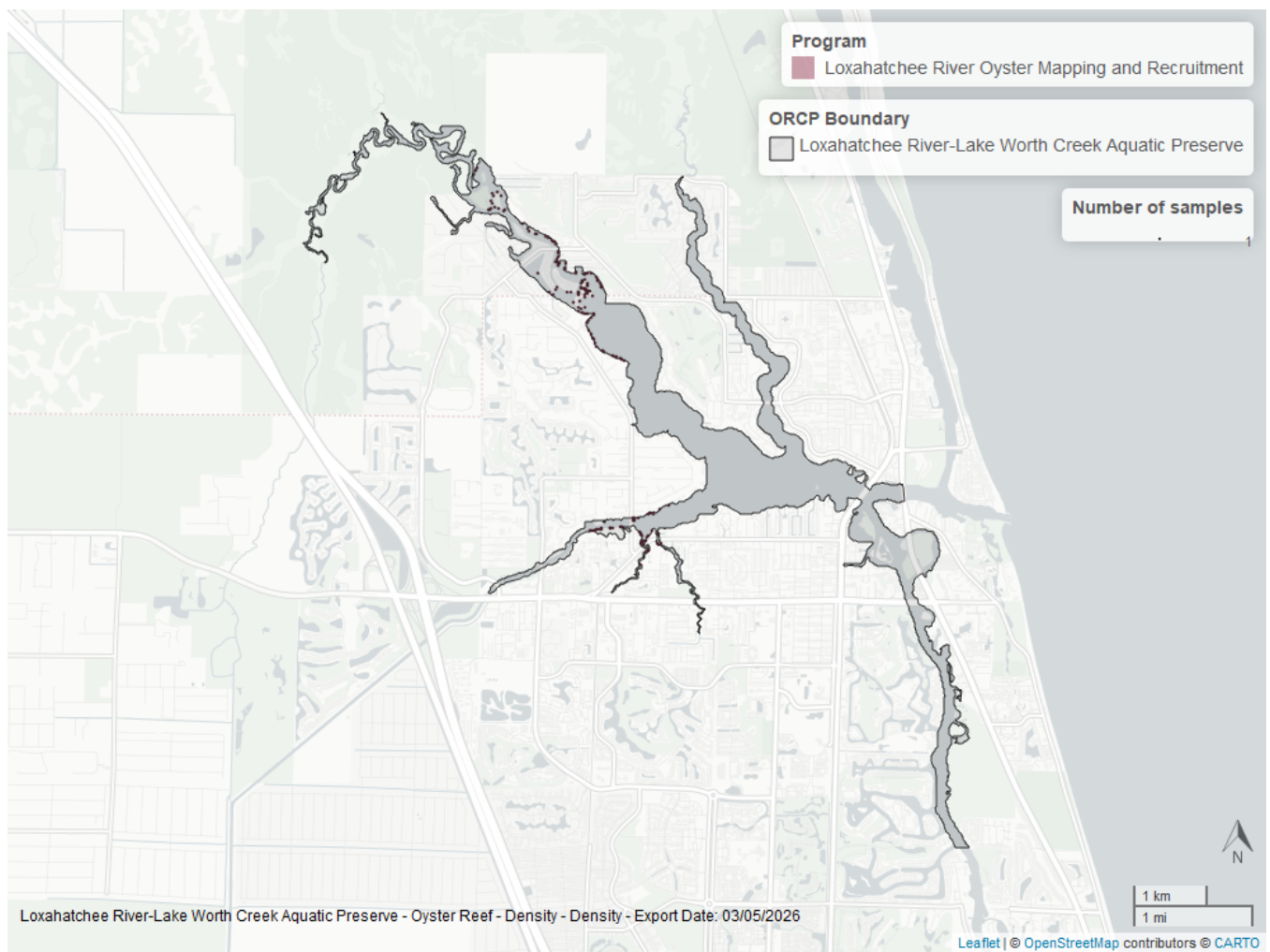


Figure 34: Map showing location of oyster density sampling locations within the boundaries of *Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## Percent Live

For natural reefs, there was insufficient data to calculate a trend for percent live cover.

Natural

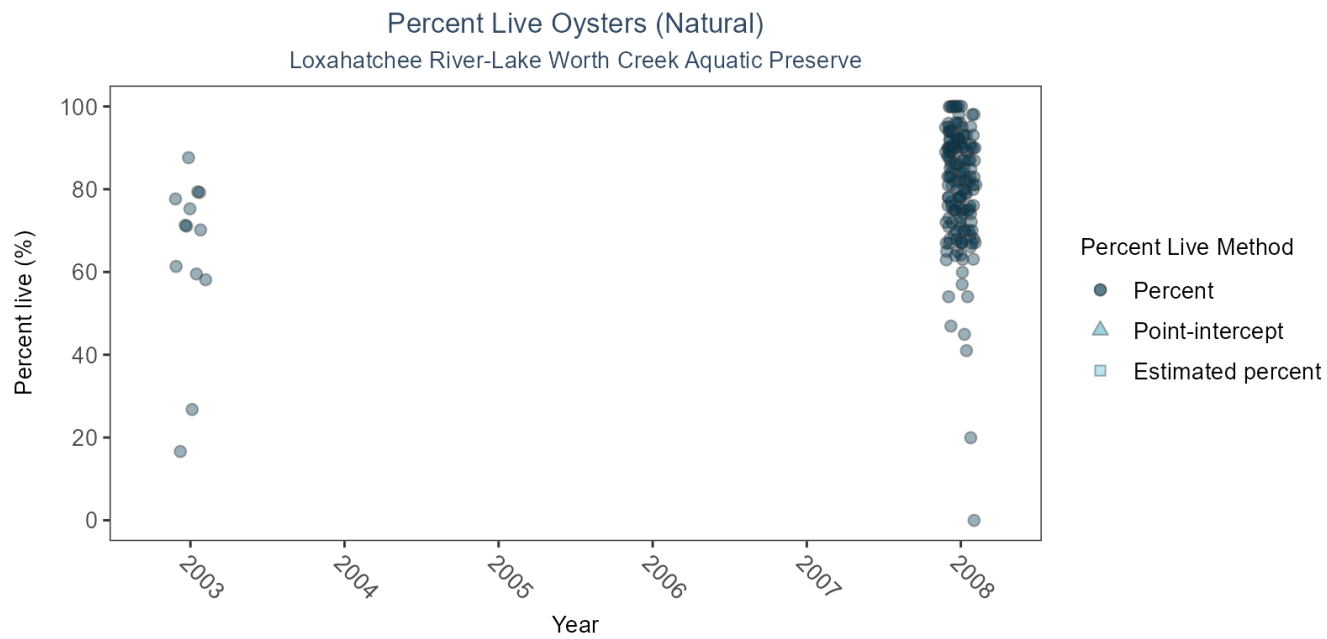


Figure 35: Scatter plot of percent live oysters over time. If the time series included five or more years with observations, an estimated trend (blue line) and a 95% credible interval (purple band) may also be plotted. Estimation method is represented as percent (circles), point-intercept (triangle), or estimated percent (square), with data points jittered horizontally to reduce overlap.

Table 35: Model results for Oyster Percent Live - Natural

| <i>Habitat Type</i> | <i>Shell Type</i> | <i>Statistical Trend</i> | <i>Period of Record</i> | <i>Estimate</i> | <i>Standard Error</i> | <i>Credible Interval</i> |
|---------------------|-------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------|-----------------|-----------------------|--------------------------|
| Natural             | Live Oysters      | Insufficient data        | 2003 - 2008             | -               | -                     | -                        |

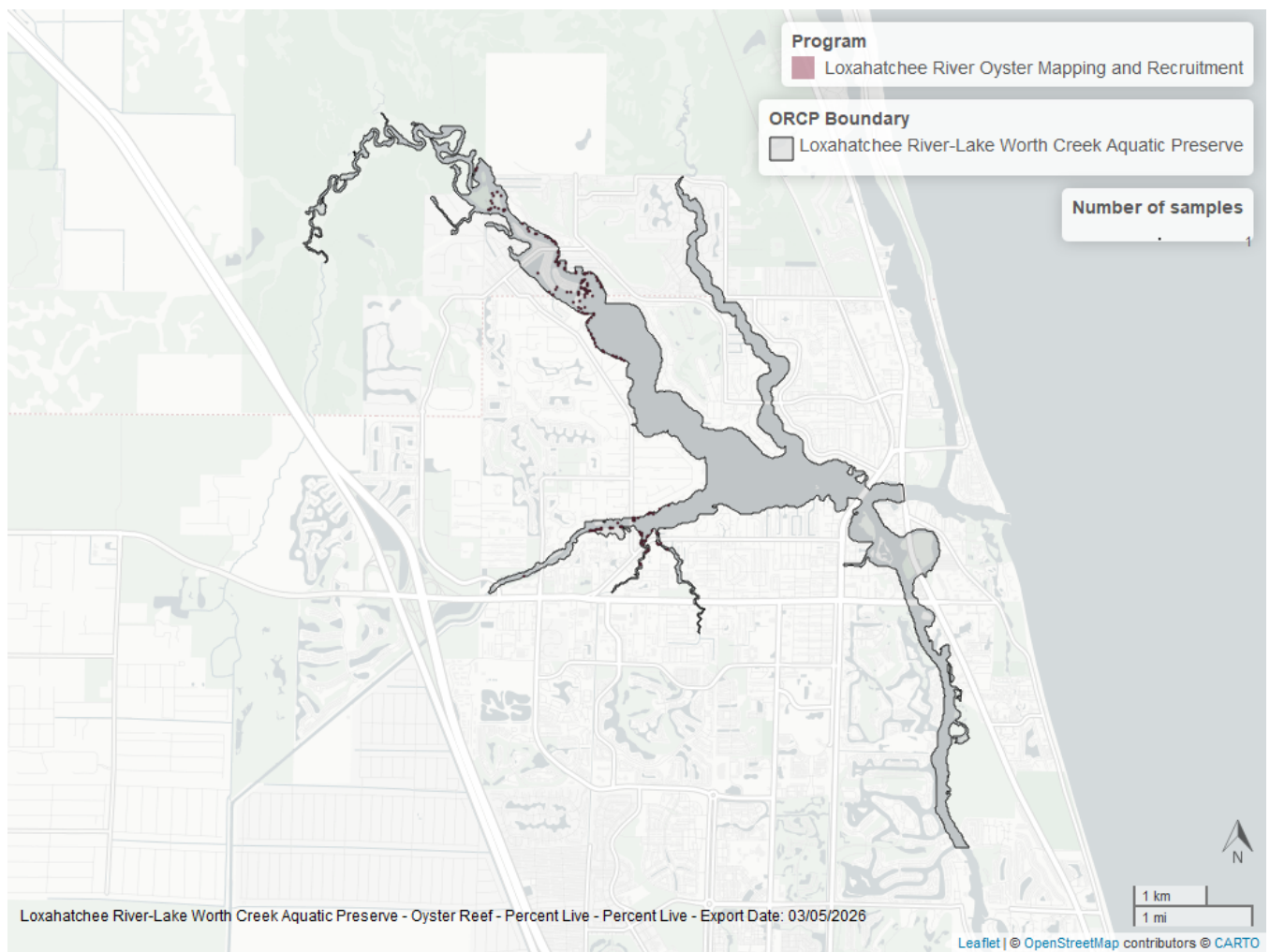


Figure 36: Map showing location of oyster percent live sampling locations within the boundaries of *Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## Shell Height

For natural reefs, there was insufficient data to calculate a trend for live oysters in either the 25-75mm or the  $\geq 75$ mm size class.

## Natural

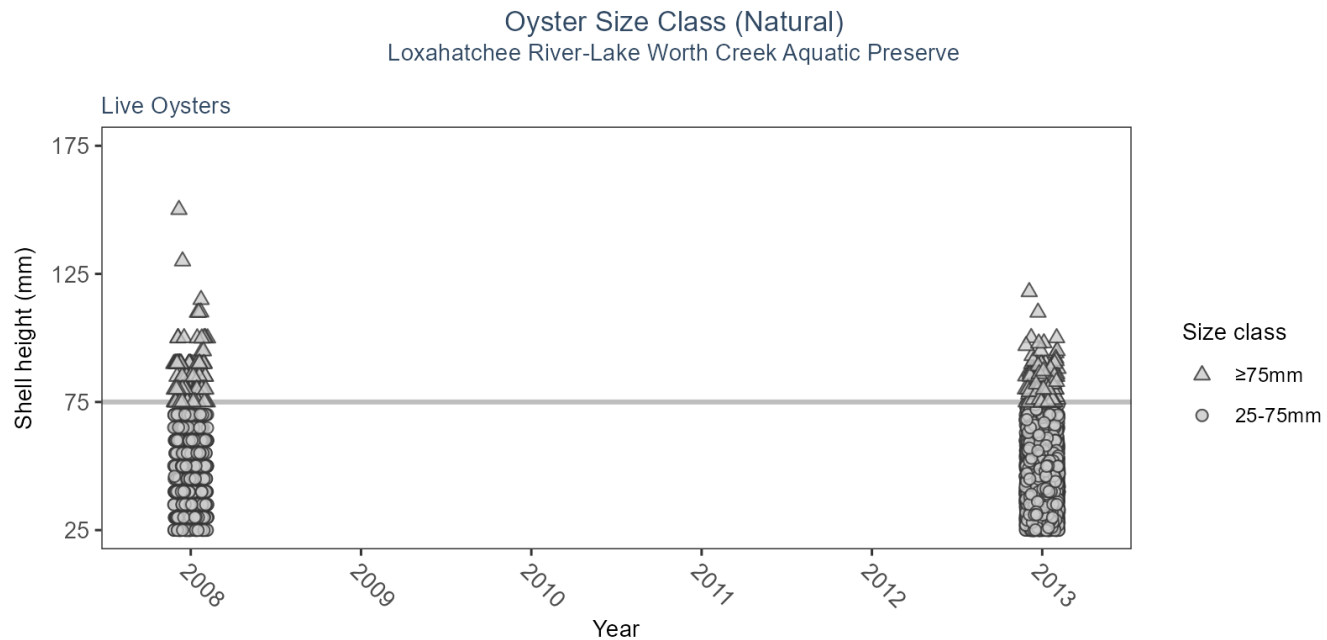


Table 36: Model results for Oyster Shell Height - Natural

| <i>Habitat Type</i> | <i>Shell Type</i> | <i>SizeClass</i> | <i>Statistical Trend</i> | <i>Period of Record</i> | <i>No. of Samples</i> | <i>Estimate</i> | <i>Standard Error</i> | <i>Credible Interval</i> |
|---------------------|-------------------|------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------|-----------------------|--------------------------|
| Natural             | Live Oysters      | >75mm            | Insufficient data        | 2008 - 2013             | 278                   | -               | -                     | -                        |
| Natural             | Live Oysters      | 25-75mm          | Insufficient data        | 2008 - 2013             | 3465                  | -               | -                     | -                        |

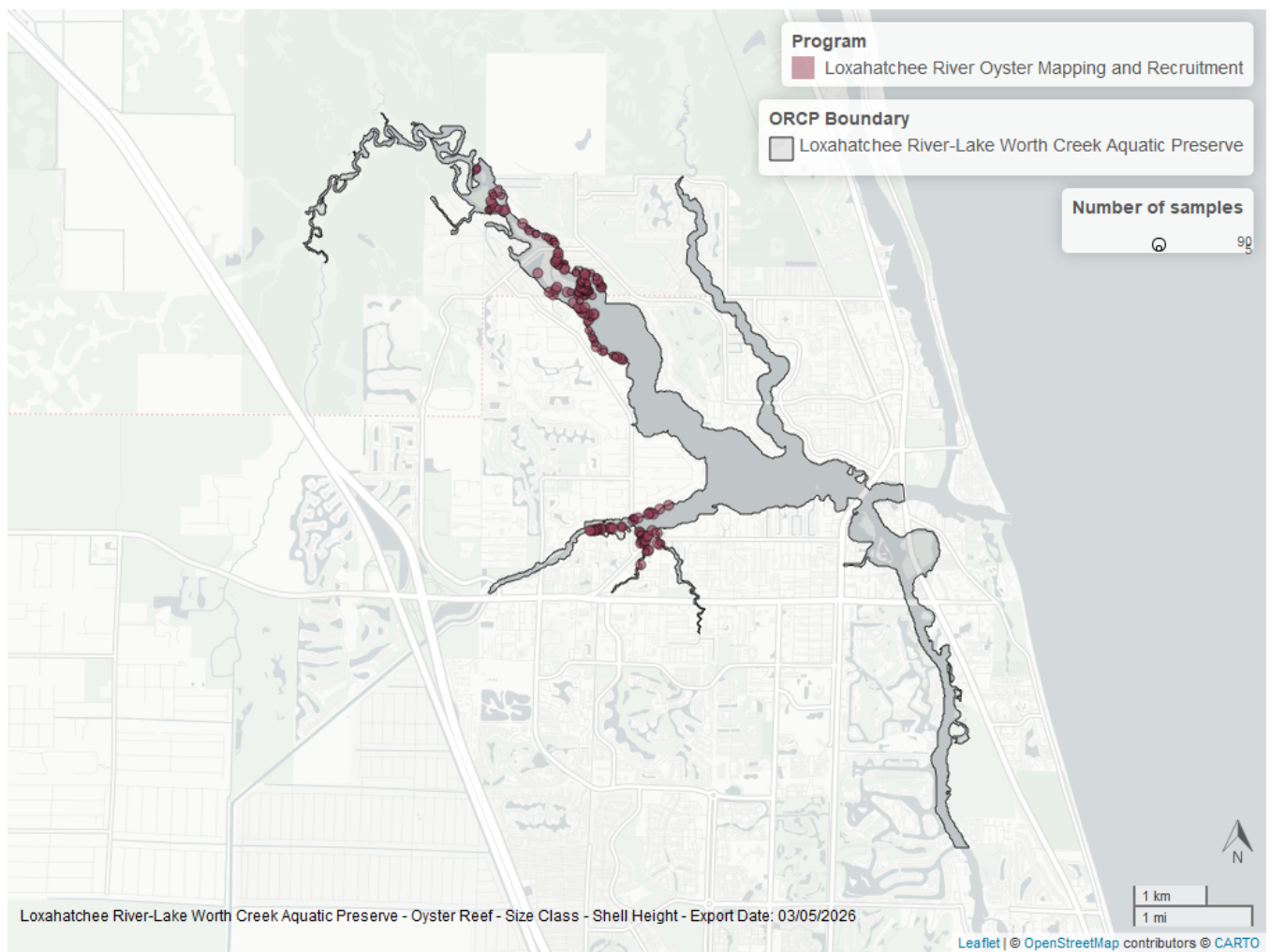


Figure 37: Map showing location of oyster shell height sampling locations within the boundaries of *Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## Species list

|                                  |                                    |                               |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Bare substrate                   | Halophila engelmannii <sup>1</sup> | Total macroalgae <sup>1</sup> |
| Caulerpa <sup>1</sup>            | Halophila johnsonii <sup>1</sup>   | Total SAV <sup>1</sup>        |
| Drift algae <sup>1</sup>         | Ruppia maritima <sup>1</sup>       | Total seagrass <sup>1</sup>   |
| Halodule wrightii <sup>1</sup>   | Syringodium filiforme <sup>1</sup> | Bare substrate                |
| Halophila decipiens <sup>1</sup> | Thalassia testudinum <sup>1</sup>  | Caulerpa <sup>1</sup>         |

1 - Submerged Aquatic Vegetation

## References

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6. Florida Fish and Wildlife Conservation Commission (FWC); Florida Fish and Wildlife Research Institute (FWRI). [Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network](#). (2018).
7. U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA). [EPA STORage and RETrieval Data Warehouse \(STORET\)/WQX](#). (2023).
8. U.S. Geological Survey (USGS). [National Water Information System](#). (2024).
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10. Loxahatchee River District; Wildpine Ecological Laboratory. [Loxahatchee River District Landscape-Scale Seagrass Mapping Area](#). (2022).